THE NEWS-PRESS

ONE YEAR AFTER SEPTEMBER 11

Reflecting on change

After the attacks, most Southwest Floridians got back to their daily routines. Yet some were deeply scarred and still struggle to recover.



PHOTO ILLUSTRATION BY JEREMY GILBERT

Life hasn't changed much for most of us.

Sept. 11 is slipping into history, despite the memorials and commemorative coverage today. The war on terrorism — with no new attacks here — is no longer on most of our minds day to day.

This wasn't supposed to happen.

Last year on this date, the media and the experts they interviewed pounded home the message that America had changed forever. That things would never be the same.

They talked of less privacy, more searches, more murders on the home soil, constant threats to Americans' resources.

They also told the stories of people whose lives changed the moment the first plane struck the World Trade Center at 8:46 a.m. Sept. 11, and the moments that the three other planes went down and the towers fell.

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Lives of some Southwest Floridians still are disfigured and raw from the attacks. The wounds are open, the victims in shock or pure pain.

A LaBelle woman lost her brother. A pair of Fort Myers-based nurses worked at ground zero and then plunged into months of depression. A LaBelle father and son were thrown in jail in a post-attack crackdown against perceived terrorists. The wife of a former Fort Myers police officer was killed on one of the hijacked planes.

Yet for most, the tragedy and aftermath was one step removed.

Then and now.

They stared at TVs on this day last year, letting the images of planes crashing into the towers sear themselves into their memories.

They donated blood and wrote out checks. They let their road rage dissolve. They bought nylon flags to fly from car windows.

Then Old Glory became tattered and faded. When a flag flew off a car in traffic, no one circled back to pick it up.

The honking returned.

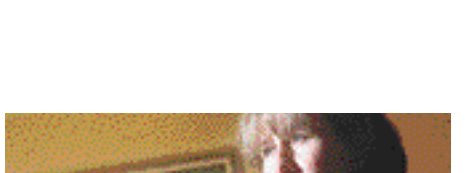
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"It was so devastating you can't forget, you don't want to. It's like people aren't talking about it because it's like an old wound they want to heal."

— MARY RUDE, 43, A BUCKINGHAM RESIDENT



FORGING AHEAD **HEROES**
Veteran firefighter Jerry Sanford of Naples isn't tired of the hero label thrust on firefighters. In fact, he's doing what he can to make sure no one ever forgets the sacrifices of Sept. 11.
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COPING **BATTLING GRIEF**
After Denise Crant died in the attacks on the World Trade Center, her family in Southwest Florida fought through sorrow and shock. Now the Crants focus on family and how precious life is.
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Barnacle Phil's owners were happy to donate the dollar bills on its walls to firefighters and their families. They weren't ready for what happened next.
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FROM THE FRONT

One year after: Change wrought by 9-11 unfelt by many

Nation's new landscape tempered by Americans' well-proven determination to move ahead • Betsy Clayton reports



A MURAL OF DOWNTOWN NEW YORK CITY PHOTO BY ANDREW WEST

The daily grind tugged us away from patriotism and toward routine thoughts — did the dog get fed this morning? Who's picking up the kids from soccer practice? When is my boss's next vacation?

Most people only occasionally found themselves reminded of the tragedy.

Like when they ran in for a quick slice at Antonio's Pizza in downtown Fort Myers and glanced at the mural on the opposite wall.

Even today it's there.

New York City's skyline stretches from the front window nearly to the back door, about the length of a semi. The twin towers of the World Trade Center — painted with the rest of the mural in 2000 — still stand. Steely and strong, symbols of American success.

Customers are reminded of where the nation's attention has been directed since the Sept. 11 terrorist attacks that doomed those towers.

New York City's image will never look the same.

Southwest Floridians come and go, eat slices of pie and maybe for a split-second wonder whether they still are the same as they were on Sept. 10, 2001.

For the last 365 days, the last 52 weeks, the last 12 months, time has trudged on. Regardless of such thoughts.

Now the recollections of Sept. 11 will begin to be counted in years.

■

If last year experts from the Brooklyn Bridge to the Golden Gate Bridge told us the American psyche would be forever changed, then what will they say today?

Was it changed?

Is it too soon to know?

Did the souring economy and some inconveniences — such as tighter airport security — alter people's daily lives?

For some people, no.

They have not changed what they do from the time they hit the radio alarm clock and sip their morning coffee on their Southwest Florida lanai to the time they see another crimson sunset end another day.

They read headlines such as "NYC reduces list of 9-11 victims' names by 4" — a story that didn't make the front page in Florida papers — as neutrally as they read headlines about recent events in East Timor. They make more mental notes about their 401(k)s and the rash of summer kidnappings than they do today of the repercussions of the Sept. 11 terrorist attacks in New York and Washington, D.C.

But is that so wrong?

The American way is to unite and forge on.

We did.

To keep a stiff upper lip.

We did.

To feel sadness for a time and then acknowledge that even if time doesn't heal all wounds, there's no use continuously contemplating anything too long.

"It was so devastating you can't forget; you don't want to," said Mary Rude, 43, a Buckingham resident who thinks about Sept. 11 often. "It's like people aren't talking about it because it's like an old wound they want to heal."

People can't make sense of it, she said.

"Now if you say 9-11, people avert their eyes and change the subject. I don't think people want to talk about it anymore."

■

There is no way anyone could walk through the final months of 2001 and into 2002 and not have encountered the story of someone affected directly by the four plane crashes and their aftermath.

North Fort Myers parents Ellis and Hilda Crant still grieve for their daughter, Denise, who died in the World Trade Center.

Former police office Lorne Lyles of Fort Myers still struggles to rebuild his life since his wife, CeeCee, a flight attendant, died when Flight 93 went down in Pennsylvania.

Rudi Dekkers of Bonita Springs still ponders how he might have identified the men he met at Huffman Aviation, his Venice flight school where two of the terrorists learned to fly.

He can sleep at night, but it's all still puzzling.

The attacks affected him on other fronts, too. It shows when he looks in the mirror each morning.

"I've lost 40 pounds since Sept. 11," said Dekkers, 46. "I started to realize life is short and I had to think about my health."

Ron Fortier's worklife changed.

When the North Fort Myers man was trained as a security screener for International Terminal Services at Southwest Florida International, he got two days of instruction in "spotting guns and hand-grenades, things of that nature."

Since Sept. 11, the list of hazardous carry-ons is much longer.

If a bottle of wine has been previously opened, "we have to sniff the cork" to make sure the bottle doesn't conceal a chemical explosive, Fortier said.

And, "those sharks in (bottles of) formaldehyde, from The Shell Factory: We don't allow them. Formaldehyde is very corrosive."

Daily checking trinkets: Every time he inspects a bag the task is a reminder of the tragedy a year ago.

■

Most people don't have daily reminders. Some never talk about it.

Talk about it or not, some people find themselves in situations that wouldn't have existed before terrorists turned America's passenger planes into human-cargo bombs.

There's the 35-year-old Cape Coral mother who recently teared up over something minor — was it a stressful work situation? A sad moment on a TV show? A finger she cut while preparing dinner?

Linda Johnson doesn't remember.

But she does remember this: When her 4-year-old son saw her crying, he asked, "Mommy, are the airplanes crashing into the buildings again?"

There's 11-year-old Max Pegues of Cape Coral, who has trouble discussing the monumental tragedy because it is tied too closely to a personal one. His grandmother died three days after Sept. 11 last year. Has his daily life changed because of the terrorist attacks?

"When I come home from school, my grandpa is there and my grandma isn't, and I think about it," he answers.

Sometimes when he tries to talk with his grandfather about the attacks, the man looks away.

"When my grandma comes up, it's hard not to recall the towers," Max said. "You can't get your mind off it because it's going to be with you a while."

■

Are the effects of the attacks extreme and ever present?

Or are they rarely thought of?

The potential exists today — Sept. 11, 2002 — to relive the terror and the trauma.

Today could immerse Southwest Floridians and Americans in a day many would like to forget.

The memories might be triggered by flipping through the newspaper or flicking on the television just to check the forecast for potential storms.

Maybe overhearing a conversation in an elevator will cause the flashback. Maybe it'll be seeing a firefighter outside a station while commuting to work.

For Doris Colgate, it could happen when she makes a business call. The Offshore Sailing School co-owner picks up the phone at the Fort Myers office to talk to her instructors at the school's branch on the Hudson River. Those staffers watched the towers fall last year.

"I don't ever want to see the pictures of those planes going in and the buildings going down," said Colgate, 61.

The former New Yorker won't revisit them today.

What about next year on Sept. 11?

No, she said. "I'll be tired of it."

The events of Sept. 11 are what she talks about with husband Steve or longtime Manhattan-based girlfriends.

She discusses it with an unfamiliar face only when pressed. She probably won't do that again either.

"It affected my mind-set," she said. "It's still: How could this have happened?"

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THE NEWS-PRESS REPORTERS **MIKE HOYEM** AND **LAURA RUANE** CONTRIBUTED TO THIS REPORT

VOICES FROM YOUR BACK YARD

In what ways have residents in Southwest Florida changed their lives? And what rights would they be willing to give up to feel more secure? The following comments were gleaned from people who attended three town hall meetings put on by The News-Press and NBC-2.

NAME: Linda Husz
AGE: 49
RESIDENCE: Fort Myers

■ **Are you living your life differently?**

"I don't live my life differently. I think I perceive it differently.



... I don't change my habits, my rituals, my life, I don't live out of fear every day..."

■ **Is there any type of privacy that you aren't willing to give up in the name of security?**

"I think some things are privileges that we've taken for granted and considered to be rights and in fact you have to earn certain rights. When someone tries to take it away from you you consider it a right.

Some of the security stuff at the airport, going through your suitcase and stuff ... I'm for it. It's just something I think we have to accept and give up."

■

NAME: Novella Duke
AGE: 34
RESIDENCE: Fort Myers

CHANGE: "I'm a little more aware of things."

PRIVACY: "I think they need to know if somebody is going to be posing some kind of a threat."

■

NAME: Daniela Valmer
AGE: 36
RESIDENCE: Fort Myers

CHANGE: "I'm more aware of my



surroundings. If I see suspicious things I go report it. I didn't find out that a classmate died until much later, but it devastated me."

PRIVACY: "I don't want cameras in certain places like libraries and schools. I would want them in hospitals and at sporting events."

■

NAME: Catherine Maurer
AGE: 66
RESIDENCE: North Fort Myers

CHANGE: "I think I appreciate nature a lot more and family."

PRIVACY: "I'm glad in a way that they are being much more secure and looking out for us. I think it's kind of sad we have lost a lot of our innocence in a way in feeling safer."

■

NAME: Carl Veaux
AGE: 64
RESIDENCE: Cape Coral

CHANGE: "Being more vigilant and seeing how other people interact.



If you see a strange object on the ground you look into it, you don't pass it up."

PRIVACY: "I think we need more."

■

NAME: William Maurer
AGE: 62
RESIDENCE: North Fort Myers

CHANGE: "I'm really not doing anything different than what I did before. Really just being aware of what's going on around me and being more cautious. I didn't make any drastic changes, just watching and seeing how things unfolded."

PRIVACY: "I'm optimistic. Hopefully they're moving in the right direction. It seems a little belated. These events have been going on overseas a long time, it was just a question of when it was going to come over here."

YEAR OF CHANGE

Sights, sounds seared into minds

The images of Sept. 11 and its aftermath will resonate in all our lives. From the first moments of terror to the months of mourning and recovery, a series of unforgettable video, words, sounds and pictures document our national trauma.

Since then, America is a different place. For many, patriotism and unity remain high.

As we've come together to heal, an equally memorable set of images has emerged to characterize that most remarkable evolution.

The News-Press and NBC-2 have joined forces on the Web to bring you the chapters of the last year.

MACKENZIE WARREN
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This morning, start your online experience with "Reflecting on Change," a multimedia look at how far America has come in 365 days.

Recount the months after last September, when turbulence and uncertainty gave way to faith and togetherness. Search a list of victims to see their faces and read some details about who they were.

And through national TV footage and photo galleries, recall each hour of Sept. 11 — a day we'll never forget.

As you make your way through today, log on to news-press.com to experience through video, text and audio how Southwest Florida is remembering this day.



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SEE NEWS-PRESS.COM TO SEE "PILGRIMAGE," A MULTIMEDIA LOOK INTO MEMORIALIZATION AT THE TRADE CENTER SITE

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OFFERING HELPING HANDS

Team discovers meaning, pain at ground zero

Realities of WTC site seared into minds, emotions of Florida health workers who lent compassion, expertise • Tanya Somaroo reports



FL2 DISASTER MEDICAL ASSISTANCE TEAM

PHOTO BY STEPHEN HAYFORD

The sights, smells and emotions of ground zero are still fresh in the minds of the medical professionals with the FL2 Disaster Medical Assistance Team.

It was the only team from Florida to go to New York after the terrorist attacks on the World Trade Center.

"I didn't know what to expect. Everyone had warned us about the smell," said Julie Kszych, 44, a nurse at Southwest Florida Regional Medical Center. "It wasn't the smell of death. It was the smell of burnt plastic and jet fuel."

"It's a smell I'll never forget. I can smell it now," she said as she sat nearly a year later in her Fort Myers condominium.

Kszych said working at ground zero didn't affect her as much as it did others.

Barbara Goodwin, a nurse at HealthPark Medical Center and Joyce Mason, a nurse at Southwest Florida Regional Medical Center, fell into depression and took several months to recover.

Goodwin and Kszych spent two weeks providing medical assistance, a shoulder to cry on and hugs for rescue workers.

Mason stayed for a month to organize the nurses.

"I just wanted to get to my condo and burrow in," Mason said about returning home.

Goodwin said: "I had to force myself to be around people. It was so overwhelmingly sad."

Both women received form letters from the government offering counseling and mental health services in January or February.

"I thought, 'Oh, the government recognizes that we're depressed. It must be OK. I'm obviously not the only one,'" Goodwin said with a laugh.

She and Mason said they were pretty much over their depression by that time.

Then in April, Bill Bishop, who served as the team's commander on its first trip to ground zero, died from sudden heart failure. He was 40 years old.

"It just brought us all up short again and reminded us how precious and fleeting our time is," Goodwin said.

She can't look at an American flag without getting chills and always wears a pin that reminds her of the event.

> "Going to ground zero reinforced in my heart and my mind that you have to live life to the fullest because you never know. Enjoy life."

She's in tune to anything that has to do with Sept. 11 or New York.

"I fully expect something else to happen," Goodwin said.

"It's like waiting for the other shoe to drop," Mason agreed.

Mason and Goodwin still get teary-eyed when they talk about ground zero.

"I have good days and I have bad days," Goodwin said. "I still can't watch it on TV and not start to cry."

The events made Mason and Kszych reach out to their loved ones.

"I want to make more time for my family and my friends," Mason said.

"Going to ground zero reinforced in my heart and my mind that you have to live life to the fullest because you never know," Kszych said. "Enjoy life. Do what you have to. Don't put things off."

All three said the event brought the team closer, but at the same time drove them apart.

"It's difficult to get a group of us together without feeling the pain," Mason said.

Despite that, they have planned a picnic for the team on Sept. 28., the day they were deployed last year.

They want to be deployed again as a team to erase the ghosts of Sept. 11 from their minds.

"Then it won't be the last thing we remember doing as a team," Goodwin said.

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FRESHMAN CADET AT WEST POINT

SPECIAL TO THE NEWS-PRESS

INSPIRED TO TAKE UP ARMS

Teen's close call bolsters patriotic plans

In D.C. on 9-11, youth now at West Point ready to fight terrorism • Mark Krzos reports

Sam Rosenberg was one of 21 students from Southwest Florida in Washington, D.C., when terrorists seized control of American Airlines Flight 77 and flew it into the Pentagon.

By the time the fire that engulfed a portion of the military's nerve center was extinguished, all 58 passengers aboard the flight and 42 civilians and military personnel were dead.

For 17-year-old Sam Rosenberg, who was just across the Potomac River participating in U.S. Rep. Porter Goss' Congressional Classroom, it was a day he'll never forget.

"We just finished a briefing in the congressman's office and were on our way down a tunnel leading to the Capitol when some armed guards turned us back," said Rosenberg, who started his freshman classes at the United States Military Academy at West Point this week.

Neither Rosenberg, a Canterbury School senior at the time, nor any of the students had any idea that America was under attack in the morning hours of Sept. 11.

He didn't know that terrorists just flew two airliners loaded with fuel into the World Trade Center towers or that another hijacked airliner was headed toward Washington.

Soon after returning to Goss' office, the group was ushered back to the congressman's house.

On the way, Rosenberg and the other students saw people pulling their cars to the side of the road and getting out.

A look of disbelief could be seen on their faces, he said.

"Then I heard a reporter talking about the World Trade Center and say, 'I can see people jumping. I can see people jumping.'" That's when Rosenberg knew it was more than a plane crash. "The only time I felt scared was when we heard a report that a plane was headed for the Capitol."

Then the third plane hit the Pentagon and both World Trade Center towers collapsed in a cloud of smoke, cement and rubble.

Meanwhile, back in Fort Myers, Rosenberg's mother, Carol, was preparing herself for the news no mother wants to hear.

"It was frightening not knowing where he was, not being able to talk to him," she said.

Shortly before 11 a.m., the phone rang and Goss' office told Rosenberg that her son and the students accompanying him were safe.

Rosenberg remained at Goss' home until 5:30 p.m.

When Washington's subway system began rolling again, he was on his way back to his hotel.

From his hotel room that night, Rosenberg watched the black billowing smoke rise from the Pentagon — a mere half-mile away.

Rosenberg's outlook on life since that day hasn't changed much, both he and his mother say.

"He always wanted to go to West Point, and he's always been a patriotic kid," said Carol, who explained that Sam's role model is Secretary of State Colin Powell. "He's always been interested in history, politics and the military."

After Sept. 11, Rosenberg said no one would consider his patriotism to be corny. "I wasn't one of the people who went out and bought a flag, because I already had one," he said.

The only thing that has changed is Rosenberg's desire to be physically involved in the military.

"Before Sept. 11, I wasn't sure if I wanted to go into combat arms or the JAG corps," he said, referring to the military's legal branch. "Now I'm sure I want to get into combat arms. Everyone here wants to be a Ranger. I'd love to. I want to do something that has an impact. I don't want a desk job. I want to help fight terrorism."

West Point is already preparing Rosenberg for his fight against terrorism and his future.

"It's mentally more difficult than I thought it would be," said Rosenberg, breaking away to ask permission from another cadet to continue his interview. "You're constantly under pressure and you're expected to work well under pressure."

So far, he says, he has no regrets about the life he has chosen for himself.

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YEAR OF CHANGE

Healing elusive for loved ones

Ada Hernandez of LaBelle lost her younger brother, Angel Pabon, in the terrorist attacks on the World Trade Center last year.

Pabon, 53, was a managing director at securities brokerage Cantor Fitzgerald, the firm hit hardest in the attack.

"We just can't get past losing my brother," Hernandez said. "We're just hanging in there trying to keep the family together and support each other."

Hernandez said it's difficult to come to terms with her brother's sudden death because "they never found anything."

"Our family is just brokenhearted," she said. "You cry all the time. Even little things remind you of him."

Her sister-in-law, niece, nephew and another brother still live in New York. Her niece and nephew still work in the financial district.

But Hernandez said she doesn't worry about another terrorist attack.

"There's nothing you can do," she said. "You have to have faith in the Lord and pray that this doesn't happen again."

Hernandez plans to go to New York for the planned memorial, to remember her brother and see his family.

"My niece is getting ready to have a baby," she said.

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PHOTO BY CLINT KRAUSE

YEAR OF CHANGE

Family second to soldiering for reservist

If Brian Bancroft is worried about going to war, he buries his feelings behind a twinkling smile and a devil-may-care attitude.

"Honey, we'll be fine," the 52-year-old Air Force reservist said to his wife, Laura, about the family finances. "You won't have to feed me — the food bill will be cut in half."

Brian grins and Laura manages a wan smile.

He's yet to receive the call he expected every time the phone rang in those first few weeks after Sept. 11.

Time pushed the anticipation of war aside. More pressing things — a new home under construction, a cell phone that jingles frequently, a wife and a stepson — demand his attention.

But Bancroft's bags remain packed, his heart and mind ready for the call should it come.

He knows something of what to expect. He fought in Vietnam but the experience doesn't dissuade him from serving his country again. Age doesn't matter either. He's combat tested — an edge those young men and women can't match.

Laura knows this, and it hurts.

"I have one thing to say for the record on this," she said, suddenly breaking self-imposed silence. "This past year I've learned my husband is a soldier first and a husband second. I didn't know that until this year, and it's hard."

She keeps a statue of Buddha outside the front door.

For a moment her talkative husband falls silent, and when he speaks again he chokes.

"I don't know what she'd do without me."

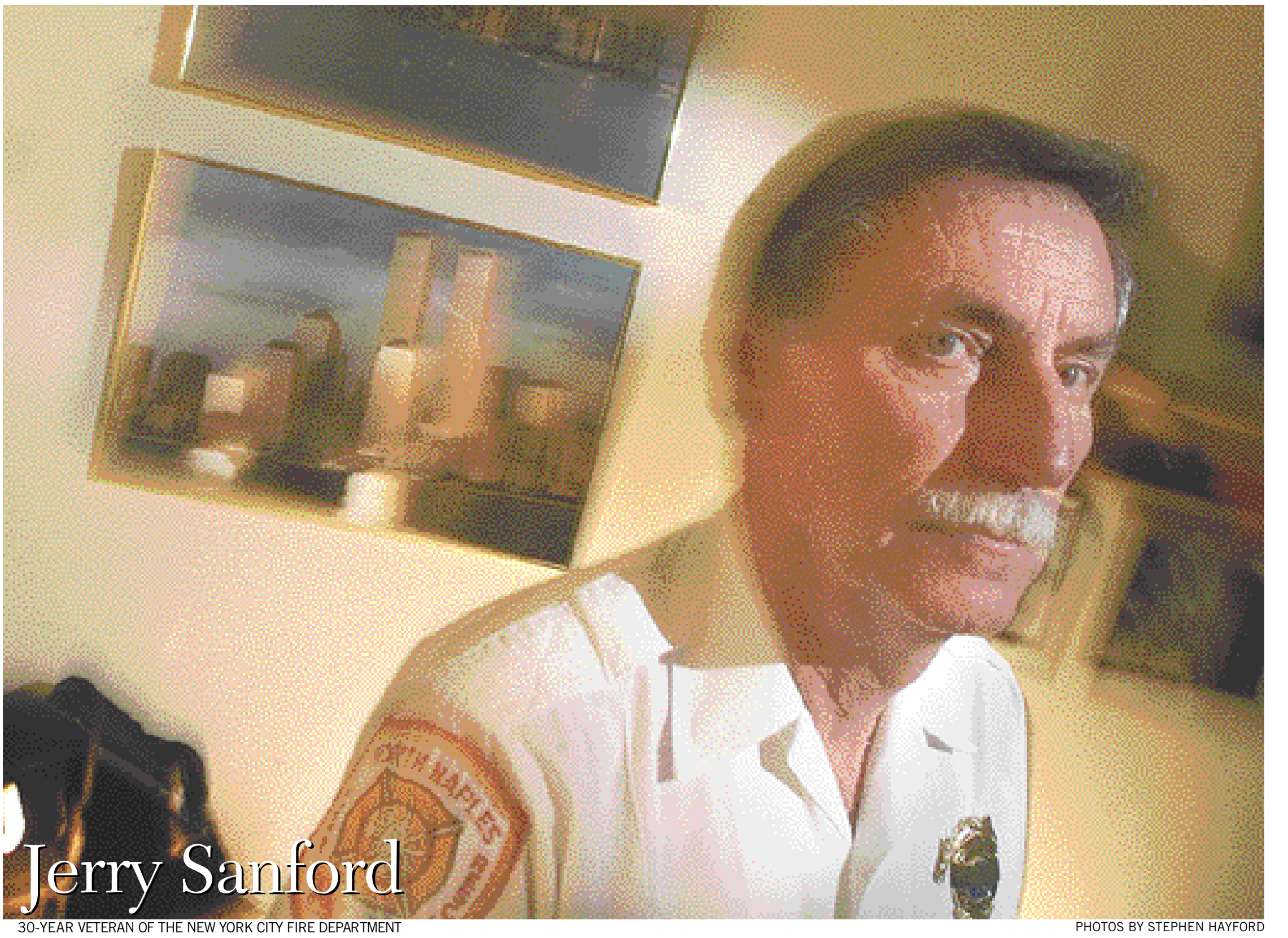
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KEEPING THE MEMORY ALIVE

Anger burns in firefighter robbed of comrades

Naples resident with New York connections lost friends, colleagues who were simply doing their jobs • Mark Stephens reports



30-YEAR VETERAN OF THE NEW YORK CITY FIRE DEPARTMENT

PHOTOS BY STEPHEN HAYFORD

"I don't want other people to forget Sept. 11, and the sacrifice those people made .... I still have a hatred for the cowards that did this. How can they destroy 2,819 lives, leave so many children as orphans? There is no place on earth for people like that."

Jerry Sanford's wounds won't heal, and so far, he doesn't really want them to.

The 30-year veteran of the Fire Department of New York City lost a lot of friends Sept. 11. He knew, or knew the families and friends of more than 100 of the 343 men in the department who died.

Over the past year, the country's anger and grief may have eased some, but his pain is still too strong to let him move on.

"As time goes on, we have a tendency to forget. I find that a little troubling," said the 64-year-old, who retired to Florida in 2000, got bored and quickly went back to work as a public relations officer for the North Naples Fire Department.

"I don't want other people to forget Sept. 11 and the sacrifice those people made.

"I'm still wearing this across my badge," he said, pointing to the small black band that normally comes off after a firefighter's funeral.

"I don't know when I'll take it off. When I get it right in my head, maybe I'll take it off. Maybe I'll never take it off."

One of the worst moments for Sanford in the year since Sept. 11 was when the operation at ground zero shifted from "rescue" to "recovery," surrendering hope of finding anyone alive. One of the highs was the appreciation shown by those famously flinty New Yorkers when they saw anyone in fire department garb.

Back in the city to help out, Sanford found people "looking at you, clapping, touching you, patting you. I didn't have to wait in line to get into a restaurant, I didn't pay for a meal or a hotel room. The outpouring was actually embarrassing."

Sanford said he wanted to help keep alive the sense of national unity and purpose that followed the disaster.

"I hate to say it, but it's kind of on the wane. In the months following Sept. 11, you saw flags at every home, on every car. You don't see that anymore. I find that disturbing."

"It's because it was somewhere else, like all these things — New York City, Oklahoma City, Jerusalem."



But there is a cure for that. "If they would go and see what is left, that huge hole, it just grips you."

Sanford still flies the U.S. flag at his home, and the flag of the Fire Department of New York City.

Sanford and former North Naples Chief James Tobin, Deputy Chief Wayne Jones, and North Naples resident George Kunze Jr. had gone to New York to attend the Sept. 10 rededication of the South Bronx fire station where Kunze's father had served when it opened in 1914.

The next day, on the way home to Naples, Sanford learned of the attacks. He learned of the collapse of the World Trade Center towers on a car radio.

He knew what that meant for the firefighters and for the police and emergency medical personnel who had swarmed into the buildings.

"I was crying, I was beside myself."

If anything, Sanford is more bitter than ever toward those who attacked America.

"I still have a hatred for the cowards that did this. How can they destroy 2,819 lives, leave so many children as orphans? How can you turn the other cheek? We should hunt them down and destroy them. There is no place on earth for people like that."

His office in the North Naples station in Veterans Park is not quite a shrine to the FDNY and Sept. 11, but it's close.

Among the mementos are a group shot, with Sanford and six others around then-Mayor Rudolph Giuliani at the Sept. 10 rededication ceremony at Ladder Company 42.

There's a framed painting of the raising of the American flag in the ruins at ground zero, another painting of the workers clearing rubble, another of a coffin being borne from a church by an honor guard, a photo of a rank of firefighters in dress uniform saluting.

But the first thing a visitor notices are two 20-inch-by-30-inch framed photos of lower Manhattan, taken 11 years ago by Sanford from a helicopter, with the Trade Center Towers still gleaming in the late afternoon light.

"Four months ago, I dug them out and had them framed. Maybe I'm surrounding myself with too many remembrances, but how can I forget?"

Over the past year, Sanford has come to appreciate more deeply the things he treasures about his old department and his profession.

"I come from a department steeped in tradition and camaraderie. Firefighters are a fraternity. We can go into any fire department in the world and be welcome. That's the closeness that being in the profession brings."

It's gratifying to Sanford that a year after Sept. 11, firefighters are still enjoying the glow of public adulation.

"When you get sworn in, you take the oath to protect life and property. That's paramount."

People now have a better understanding of that oath and the traditions, training and comradeship that enliven it. They realize that a selfless sense of duty to others — not religious fanaticism or cultural hatred — can make hundreds of perfectly normal people run into burning skyscrapers, things logic and instinct tell most people to run away from as fast as possible.

His grief and pride are muted now, but they run just as strong as they did on Sept. 11 and in the gruesome days that followed.

For this native of Staten Island, the towers at the bottom of Manhattan were symbols of his city, the greatest, proudest city on earth.

"To this moment, I can't conceive those towers could fall. How can I ever be the same?"

TO CONTACT THE REPORTER **MSTEPHENS@NEWS-PRESS.COM**

GIVING STILL STRONG

One big worry — that massive Sept. 11 donations would hamper other charities — didn't prove true.

A June report estimated total 2001 giving at $212 billion, up slightly from the previous year. Sept. 11 accounted for barely 1 percent.

Recent estimates say private donors gave between $1.9 billion and $2.7 billion for victims and their families.

THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

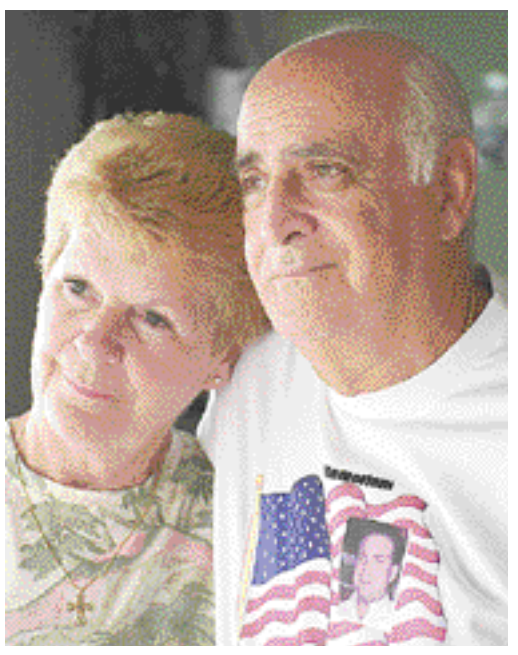


PHOTO BY CLINT KRAUSE

YEAR OF CHANGE

Family brought together, changed forever by Flight 93's tragic heroism

Superman was Joseph Nacke's favorite hero as a boy, and his family is certain Nacke acted like Superman when terrorists took over United Flight 93 on Sept. 11.

"He would have been the first one through the (cockpit) door," said Nicholas Millace of Cape Coral, Nacke's uncle.

A tooth, the only remains of Nacke recovered, was found near the cockpit at the crash site in Shanksville, Pa.

"They give you body parts, and you're lucky if you get a tooth," said Toni Millace, Nicholas' wife.

Fifty-seven family members traveled to Seven Springs outside Shanksville last year to remember Nacke. United Airlines helped coordinate the memorial for families of all victims.

"This strengthened our family ties," Millace said. "Families always have rifts, but we all forgot our little arguments."

The family needed each other again when Nacke's father died of heart failure six weeks after Sept. 11.

"The loss of a son was just too much for him," Millace said.

Nacke's mother, Millace's twin sister, refuses to return to her Maryland home. She now lives with a friend.

"When she's with family it's a constant reminder of Joey's loss," Millace said, looking into the distance. "It never goes away. It's always on your mind."

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SOUTH FLORIDA TOURISM HIT HARD

South Florida's tourism industry has fared the worst because much of its tourist traffic is made up of domestic air travelers and foreign tourists.

More than half of overnight visitors to Miami-Dade County travel by air, and more than half of those are international travelers.

According to Smith Travel, hotel occupancy rates in Miami-Dade County hotels have been down every week since Sept. 22.

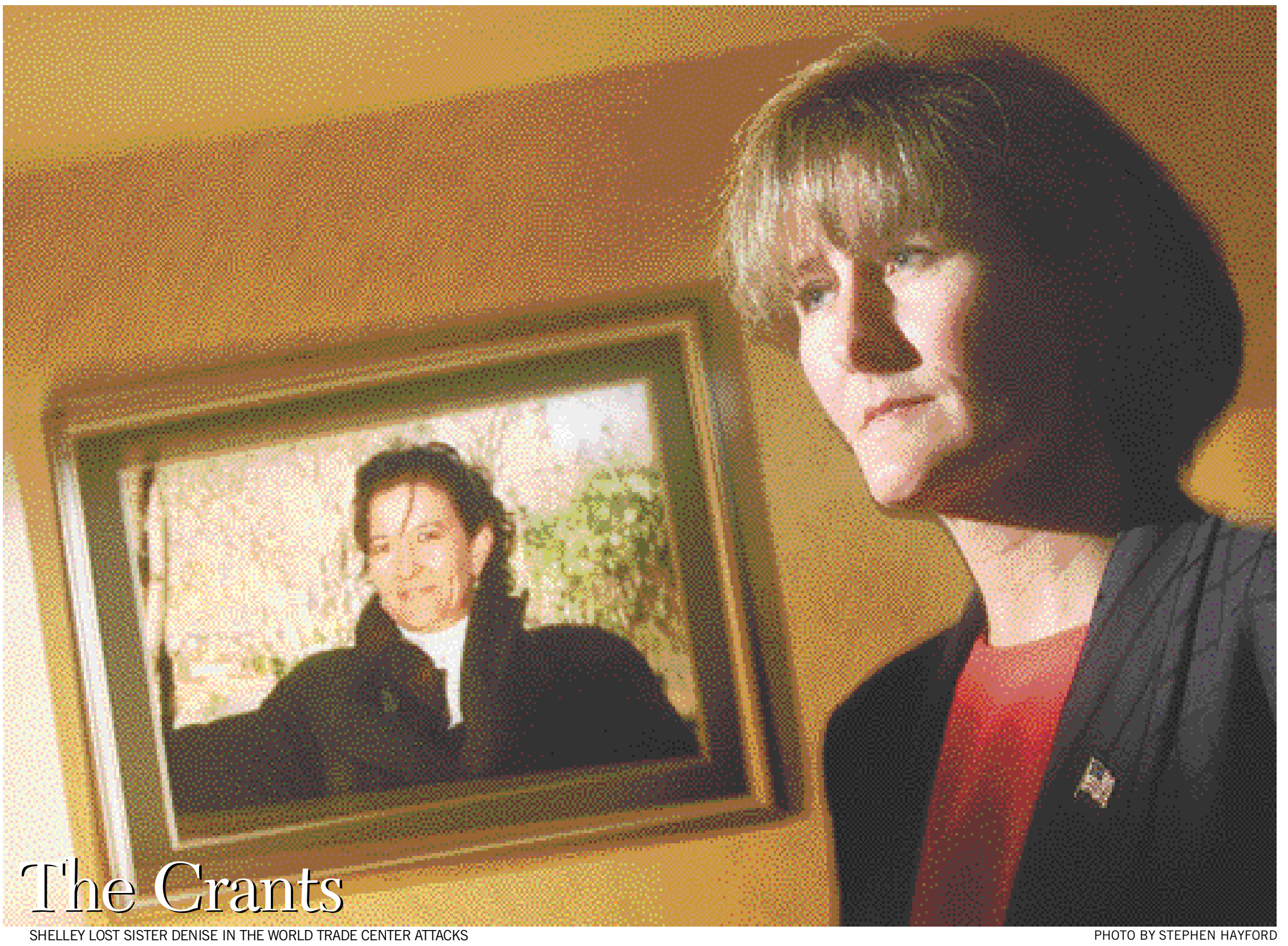
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SEE NEWS-PRESS.COM TO LEARN HOW RECOVERY HAS LED TO READINESS FOR FUTURE THREATS IN SOUTHWEST FLORIDA

GRIEVING AND GROWING

Tragedy haunts family's journey to healing

Grief, memories, hope creep into the daily routines of victim Denise Crant's family • Drew Sterwald reports



SHELLEY LOST SISTER DENISE IN THE WORLD TRADE CENTER ATTACKS

PHOTO BY STEPHEN HAYFORD

In the days following Sept. 11, John Crant was the one poring over newspapers' extra editions, checking casualty lists, talking to hospital workers.

"Probably the hardest part was I couldn't even get her name out once I sat down with them," he said.

One day last November, Shelley Crant-Baggot picked up a phone during an Orlando business trip to call her big sister.

She always called from the road. Nothing unusual — just their typical check-in chat, a chance to connect over the miles from Florida to New York.

She paused.

She remembered.

She called her little brother, John, instead.

"That was the first day I realized I couldn't call her," said Shelley, whose 46-year-old sister, Denise E. Crant, perished Sept. 11 at the World Trade Center.

A year later, a news report or a mention in a business discussion can still catch the Cape Coral resident off guard, remind her of all the other families who lost siblings, children, spouses, friends.

"There are so many sad stories," she said.

John, 39, who lives and works in Manhattan, can't escape them.

They're printed on the front page, aired on the newscasts, every single day.

Still.

Grief has become a prison with no parole in sight, he said.

From his new apartment on the Lower East Side, he would have been able to see the twin towers. Sometimes, he feels bad that he can go on working, planning a vacation, decorating a new home, when so many people lost their lives.

"I'm better now than I was six months ago, but I'm surprised at how much it's still affecting me, problemwise, day to day," he said.

Depression, anger, guilt drag on those trying to get back on their feet.

News reports might say people are putting their lives back together, but they're really struggling just to stand up, John said.

■

Far away from ground zero, Shelley and her parents try to focus on positive thoughts, recall pleasant memories.

Denise loved New York — she was where she wanted to be.

She probably didn't suffer.

She's in a better place.

"Time does have a way of softening feelings," said her father, Ellis Crant, from the family's summer home in Wisconsin Dells, Wis., where oldest son, Ellis, also lives.

"Overall, I'd say we haven't had a terribly bad year. There's no question in the world, though, when you lose a child it's very difficult."

Work goes on at their gift shop, The Sea Shell, in the tourist-magnet town where people take boat rides in giant ducks and finger faux American Indian-beaded souvenirs.

Denise's mother, Hilda, suffers from osteoporosis, so she can't work much, and her memory isn't what it used to be.

Sometimes she asks when Denise is coming home.

"She doesn't live with it as much as we all do," her husband said. "In a way, I'm thankful."

John — the "baby" of the family — has lived with it more than anyone else.

"Sept. 11 is going to hit him hard," his father predicted.

That morning a year ago, John was talking on the phone with Shelley when he overheard a commotion among his coworkers. The second airliner hadn't even hit yet.

He raced downtown, thinking he might somehow find Denise amid the chaos.

No trace of her or anybody else who worked at Marsh USA in the north tower has ever been found. The Crants received an urn of general ashes from ground zero.

But in the days following Sept. 11, John was the one poring over newspapers' extra editions, checking casualty lists, talking to hospital workers.

"Probably the hardest part was I couldn't even get her name out once I sat down with them," he said.

■

Denise's death was a shocking introduction to mortality and grief for John and Shelley. Never before had they lost someone so close.

Years ago, they all worked together at Cande's, their parents' former restaurant in the Cape. Denise and Shelley lived together for a while in Arizona, sharing clothes and hiking in the desert.

Ironically, they'd talked once, after Lockerbie or some other plane crash that claimed many lives, about how those left behind coped with such public loss.

The answer?

"Concentrate on daily routine," said Shelley, 42.

Despite the international scale of the event, she felt isolated. She still wears an American flag pin. It makes her feel better.

Then the cards and calls started coming in from old buddies, friends of her sister's, strangers even.

A cousin who teaches in Orlando sent letters of condolence written by her high school class.

"When I first saw the letters, it was just amazing to me the level of emotion and caring that came from these students who really did not know us, but tried so sincerely to share their feelings and show their support," Shelley said.

"It helped to know people were thinking about you."

The world felt a little smaller, the family even closer than the tight-knit bunch it already had been.

Having complete strangers reach out to them became a lesson in how to comfort others in pain.

"I've never been good at dealing with other people when they're dealing with a loss," John said.

"All you have to do is call them up the moment you hear and tell them they are in your prayers or in your thoughts."

■

Rather than challenge their faith in God or sharpen a desire for vengeance, Denise's death served as a poignant reminder of how precious life and family and time are.

"You have to enjoy your family every day," Ellis said. "Be sure and tell them you love them. We don't know the hour we'll be taken."

A church deacon in Wisconsin and at St. Francis Xavier Catholic Church in Fort Myers, the North Fort Myers resident speaks to his late daughter in prayer, asks her to watch over the family.

Perhaps she is.

On a Saturday last March, Ellis woke up and felt compelled to go to St. Francis in the morning, even though he routinely assists at afternoon Mass. He hadn't even read the church bulletin, where dedications are printed.

When the service started, the priest announced it was being celebrated in honor of Denise Crant.

"I'm better now than I was six months ago, but I'm surprised at how much it's still affecting me, problemwise, day to day."

— JOHN CRANT, DENISE'S BROTHER

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YEAR OF CHANGE

Faith, memories, family help Fort Myers widower make it through tough times

Mornings are a tough part of Lorne Lyles' day.

Since his wife CeeCee Lyles died when her plane crashed into a field in Pennsylvania during the terrorist attacks on America, the Fort Myers man's sleep has been fitful.

"I never planned to be alone," he said during a news conference earlier this year. "Now I have to raise my kids alone. I feel cheated."

CeeCee Lyles was an attendant on United Airlines Flight 93, which crashed while passengers attempted to regain control.

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Lyles says it's faith, happy memories and his sons, Jerome, 16; Justin, 11; Jordan, 10; Jevon, 7; and Jarrell, 6, that get him through the low days.

"I know the Lord doesn't make mistakes," said Lyles, a former Fort Myers Police officer.

He left that job in April, citing personal reasons.

Now friends say he splits his time between his home in Fort Myers; Fort Pierce, where CeeCee is buried; and Tampa, where other family members live.

Jere Longman, who wrote the book "Among the Heroes" about Flight 93, said Lyles was among the most despondent of all the victims' loved ones.

Lyles told reporters in March that he talks to CeeCee in his prayers, telling her about the boys and asking her to watch over them.

There's no easy way to patch the hole CeeCee has left.

During the day, the Lyles family takes comfort in a homemade memorial to CeeCee they put together on a living room end table.

A model of a Boeing 757 and a picture of CeeCee in her flight uniform sit on the table. A framed print of an airborne jet signed by United Airlines employees hangs on the wall above it.

"That's our memorial," said Lyles earlier this year. "We talk to it. We kiss it. It's helped with the healing process."

The longing lingers into the night.

Lyles told Longman he sprays CeeCee's perfume on a teddy bear and places it next to him as he sleeps.



PHOTO BY CLINT KRAUSE

THE LYLES FAMILY, JUST BEFORE CEECEE DIED, LEFT TO RIGHT: JEROME, JEVON, CEECEE, JUSTIN, JORDON AND LORNE. LORNE SAYS HIS SONS HAVE GOTTEN HIM THROUGH THE LAST YEAR.

SEE NEWS-PRESS.COM FOR PROFILES OF THE VICTIMS

A SPIRIT OF GENEROSITY

Restaurant's altruism proven 10,000 times over

The donation of Barnacle Phil's dollar-bill wallpaper rewarded with more generosity, media attention • Jennifer Booth Reed reports



MANAGER AND OWNER OF BARNACLE PHIL'S HARBOR RESTAURANT ON NORTH CAPTIVA

PHOTO BY STEPHEN HAYFORD

Barnacle Phil's isn't just Barnacle Phil's, that waterside restaurant where boaters, anglers or vacationers might stop for lunch.

Today it's Barnacle Phil's, that waterside restaurant with the dollar bills.

Manager Ray Scala can hear the tour boat guides crooning over the PA systems: "And this is the restaurant where they pulled 10,000 dollars off the walls and donated it to firefighters … "

The tourists rush off the boat, dollar bills in hand, ready to partake in the giving.

Scala rolls his eyes. Word leaked about what was supposed to have been a quiet gesture of goodwill. The Today Show called. Oprah called. Then CNN and The Associated Press. It got so bad Scala could hardly prep the food in the mornings. His wife, Eva Kinsey Scala, the daughter of Barnacle Phil's founders Phil and Roberta Kinsey, became the restaurant's official spokesperson.

The little restaurant, tucked into the mangroves on North Captiva, accessible only by boat (and golf cart once on the little island), had 15 minutes of fame that have lasted for a year.

Ray Scala's glad, nevertheless, that he could play a part in helping the country cope with the aftermath of Sept. 11.

"There's all this money on the wall. It's for people. It's not for us," he said. The money went to families of rescue workers.

In old fishing villages, fishermen coming in from a good catch tacked bills to the walls of their favorite bars. When the fish stopped running and times were lean, they retrieved their money.

"In hard times the dollars come off the walls," Eva Kinsey Scala said.

She can think of no worse time than the weeks following Sept. 11.

She and her husband one Saturday morning last September invited firefighters and their families to pull faded dollar bills from plywood walls. Eva's brother Phil Kinsey Jr. is a firefighter in Bonita Springs.

The walls stood naked for only minutes. Then the firefighters began posting their own donations.

Today, a first-time visitor would hardly know the place had been stripped. Thousands of bills paper the restaurant once again.

"There's all this money on the wall. It's for people. It's not for us."

The Scalas' gesture captured the hearts of many. One family from Kentucky, who had never stepped foot in the restaurant, sent a family photograph and five $1 bills — one for each member of the family. Other patrons — actual visitors this time — fashioned a bulletin-board-sized flag out of bills. One Nation. Under God. Indivisible, read three dollars posted beneath it.

But a year later, some wonder whether Americans have lost their patriotic fervor and their sense of gratitude toward rescue workers.

Upper Captiva Fire Chief Richard Pepper remembers pulling money from the walls a year ago amid a national outpouring of thanks.

Now, he's fighting for his budget.

"When it first happened everyone was thankful the fire department was here. They were glad to see us. Now people are looking at their tax bills," Pepper said. "It's discouraging that it's gone back to business as usual that fast."

He wants to preserve the attitude Sept. 11 kindled. Ray Scala wants to preserve the restaurant's pre-Sept. 11 charm.

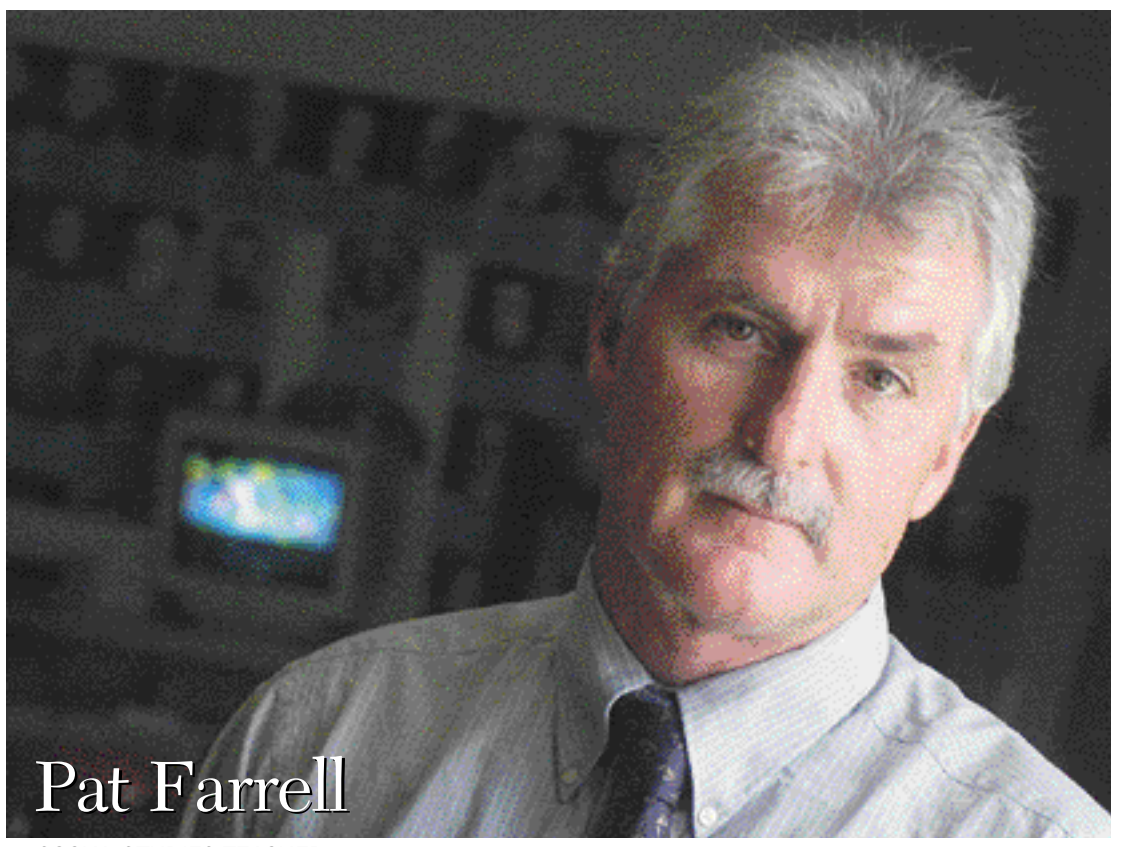
Family friends and longtime patrons begged him after the bills came down and the dingy walls were revealed not to renovate and change Barnacle's into some fancy digs.

So Scala ripped down the old plywood and put fresh planks in its place, painted a humble gray that well-suits the mismatched furniture, unadorned tables and oddball trinkets that make visitors feel like they're sitting down to dinner at a longtime friend's.

Patrons undoubtedly will continue to post their bills, scrawled with prayers and personal celebrations.

God willing, no crisis will persuade Eva and Ray Scala to take them down ever again.

TO CONTACT THE REPORTER **JREED@NEWS-PRESS.COM**



SOCIAL STUDIES TEACHER

PHOTO BY STEPHEN HAYFORD

OUT OF TRAGEDY, GRATITUDE

Family spared – three times

Three of Pat Farrell's nephews worked in the twin towers and all survived, but not without scars • Jennifer Booth Reed reports

On Sept. 11, Pat Farrell deftly conducted his social studies classes, even as he waited for news about the whereabouts of three nephews, all of whom worked in the World Trade Center.

Fate worked in the family's favor. One nephew was spending the day in his firm's New Jersey office. A second escaped the trade center early. The third fought to get out and, soot-covered and terrified, survived.

Time and distance have mostly healed Farrell's shock.

His native New York City neighborhood, however, bears the scars of the attacks.

His neighborhood lost between 12 and 14 of its own. A sadness and pain permeates the streets. It's a blue-collar kind of place, home to lots of firefighters and police and the birthplace of lifelong friendships.

"Initially we were so emotionally involved, but as the year went on we got over it," said Farrell, who visited his hometown during the summer. "I don't think their wounds have healed."

His family hasn't recovered either. His 24-year-old son Liam, who lived in New York, has reconsidered his advertising career and gone back to graduate school. One nephew is re-evaluating his job in finance and another, the one who narrowly escaped, wears a haunted look when he talks about Sept. 11.

"The anguish on his face — it seemed like he was transformed from a young guy to one with too many years . . . " Farrell said.

Hundreds of miles separate Farrell from New York, yet he nevertheless remains bound to his hometown.

On his left wrist he wears a silver bracelet engraved with the name Dennis Mulligan, a neighborhood firefighter who had befriended Farrell's son.

Mulligan died on Sept. 11, a month before he was to get married.

"The anguish on his face — it seemed like he was transformed from a young guy to one with too many years…."

TO CONTACT THE REPORTER **JREED@NEWS-PRESS.COM**



PHOTO BY ANDREW WEST

YEAR OF CHANGE

Date delivers joyous blessing amid sea of sorrow

Bruce and Rebecca Kyle were among the few people not glued to their television sets the morning of Sept. 11. They had more pressing matters.

As planes were plowing into the World Trade Center and Pentagon, "We were in the middle of the birth," said Bruce Kyle, a state representative from Fort Myers.

The couple's second son, Reece, was born just before 11 a.m. at HealthPark Medical Center in south Fort Myers.

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"It's an odd feeling," Bruce Kyle said. "You have extreme feelings of joy ... and extreme moments of sorrow — all at the same time."

It wasn't until after the delivery they learned of the terrorist attacks.

"I don't think I'll ever feel both of those emotions that strongly at the same time," he said.

Thousands perished.

The twin towers were reduced to rubble.

All flights were grounded.

Reece wasn't originally expected to arrive that day. His due date was Sept. 14.

But Rebecca, 32, had grown so big that doctors wanted to schedule the delivery. The couple chose Sept. 11 — Bruce Kyle's grandmother's birthday. Rebecca gave birth naturally. Reece weighed 8 pounds, 4 ounces.

The television remained off, a steadfast rule of Rebecca's during births. Her husband obliged.

"It was too much emotionally after what had just happened for us to turn on the TV," Bruce Kyle, 33, said.

It wasn't until that evening and the next day that the events sunk in.

"The very next day I said to Bruce, 'What happened yesterday?'" Rebecca Kyle recalled. "It was such sadness for our country but such a blessing in our family.

"It even is emotional to this day," she said. "It instantly brings tears."

"On every birthday it's going to be a time to celebrate," Bruce Kyle said. "At the same time the country will be mourning annually and remembering."

"In the long run, it'll make his birthday more unique and more special," he said.

SEE NEWS-PRESS.COM TO LEARN HOW CHILDREN'S FEARS ARE SLOW TO FADE

ENGULFED IN THE MAELSTROM

Arrests cast shadow over patriotism

Jailed on suspicion of passport-tampering, a LaBelle man and his father struggle with the country they love • Andi Atwater reports



Nacer Mustafa

LABELLE BUSINESS OWNER

THE NEWS-PRESS FILE PHOTO

"My father ... always believed in the system, that there is no place more perfect than this government. In a matter of seconds, everything he believed in ... was taken away."

In the days after terrorists attacked the United States — as Americans girded themselves in patriotism and their inalienable rights — two men for the first time questioned just how free they were.

The men, who long ago pledged their allegiance to this country, sat in a federal jail in Texas, befuddled at their arrests in the aftermath of Sept. 11.

Southwest Florida residents Fahti and Nacer Mustafa, a father and son traveling home from a business trip in Mexico, became unwitting victims of a post-attack backlash against perceived terrorists.

Nacer Mustafa, 29, spent 67 days in jail.

Fahti Mustafa, 67, was sent home after two weeks because of poor health — but was forced to wear an electronic monitoring bracelet on his ankle.

All charges against them were eventually dropped — a mistake, the government said, a "justifiable" mistake.

That mistake — the accusation that the Palestinian-American Mustafas had tampered with their passports — was more than a minor inconvenience.

Months and thousands of dollars were eaten up before the Mustafas were reunited as a family and life returned to some semblance of normalcy.

Inside, they say, they'll never be quite the same.

■

Nacer Mustafa remembers exactly what he was doing when they heard that terrorists were turning airplanes into suicide bombs.

He and his father were wrapping up their stay in León, Mexico, nationally recognized as the "shoe capital" of Mexico because of its numerous shoe factories, leather goods, gold and silver embroideries and textiles manufactured there.

The Mustafas buy such goods for their family-owned LaBelle Department Store, which features a mix of work duds, leather belts, boots, socks and underwear, mostly serving the Hispanic farm worker community.

Early in the morning, the Mustafa men set out from their Holiday Inn room to visit a longtime associate and boot manufacturer.

When they arrived on that breezy, cool September morning, their seller greeted them at the door.

"Did you hear? Did you hear what happened in the United States?" he asked the Mustafas.

They quickly turned on the television to CNN.

"It was a very terrible feeling, like your heart was falling," Nacer Mustafa said. "It was a shock to us. We just stared at it."

Later that afternoon, two blocks away at the Fiesta Americana hotel where CNN was broadcast in English, Nacer sat in the lounge and cried for his country.

■

Four days after the terrorist attacks, with the United States on full alert and every major airport in the nation under heavy surveillance, the Mustafas finally got a flight home.

On Sept. 15, they stepped off their plane in Houston, Texas, prepared to catch their final connection home to Fort Myers.

But they didn't make it past U.S. Customs.

Fahti Mustafa said he and his son were held for three hours without explanation before agents took them to jail.

Until then, Nacer Mustafa said his father was optimistic, believing wholeheartedly that whatever the problem was, it would be resolved soon.

Even as agents pulled into the jail's driveway, the senior Mustafa — who speaks limited English — assumed they were being taken to a hotel while the matter was cleared.

"My father has lived a long, honest life, and always believed that people who went to jail probably deserved it," Nacer Mustafa said. "He always believed in the system, that there is no place more perfect than this government.

"In a matter of seconds, everything he believed in for 60 years was taken away."

The Mustafas were placed in adjacent cells — tiny, concrete rooms with only a bed and a toilet that were fortified with steel doors.

The first night, the men were in shock, still overwhelmed by the sudden turn of events.

After 24 hours, the Mustafas still had no viable explanation as to why they were in jail.

"No one explained anything to me. I sat in jail without knowing what day it was or what hour it was," Fahti Mustafa said in October. "I've lived here 35 years and every time I told them the truth, they'd find something else to question me about."

They had no idea that hundreds of Middle Eastern men across the nation were being locked up under questionable circumstances.

In the quiet of the second night, Nacer Mustafa heard his father sobbing in the next cell, the sort of stifled crying a man does when he wants to hide it from other people.

"I tried to knock on the wall so he'd know I was there for him," Nacer Mustafa said softly. "I didn't care what happened to me; I was very worried about him. Both of us ... cried all night that night."



HOUSTON CHRONICLE FILE PHOTO

■

Back in LaBelle, Fatmeh Mustafa, 50, wrung her hands in constant agitation over the fate of her husband and first son.

Wearing a simple shawl over her hair as called for by her Muslim faith, Fatmeh Mustafa often used the edge of it to dab her eyes.

Fahti Mustafa had lived in the United States for almost 40 years, a U.S. citizen for more than three decades.

Her eldest son, Nacer Mustafa, is a natural citizen, born in Puerto Rico.

They and their extended family had lived in LaBelle for almost seven years.

Now they were afraid to leave it.

"I'm afraid to go to the (Edison) mall — I've even been afraid to go to the grocery store here," Hadeel Mustafa, 20, who is married to another of Fahti Mustafa's sons, said last September.

"Even on the elevator in Fort Myers, people were looking at us funny. If you have your head covered, you're scared to go" anywhere, she said.

On Sept. 30, the elder Mustafa — not considered a flight risk because of chronic illnesses such as diabetes — came home from jail after his family posted 10 percent of the $100,000 bail.

His son's bail request was denied.

■

Exactly one month after the Mustafas' arrests, a grand jury indicted the men on charges of possessing altered passports.

Federal agents at Bush Intercontinental Airport believed a top layer of laminate had been applied to their passports, a highly suspicious activity that has been linked to drugs, racketeering and terrorist activity.

Agents also were bothered by the fact that stamps in their books indicated the Mustafas have traveled to Israel, Jordan, Saudi Arabia and Mexico.

But a laboratory analysis determined that neither passport was altered.

The books, in fact, showed typical wear and tear.

"The laboratory analysis showed that the laminate had most likely 'split' and was not an additional laminate," a U.S. assistant attorney wrote in his motion to dismiss.

The charges were dropped Nov. 20. Nacer Mustafa was home by Thanksgiving.

Relieved but broke, the family tried to recoup from the government some of the hefty legal fees spent to fight the charges.

Within eight months, both requests had been denied.

The government, a judge ruled, was justified in its actions in those post-Sept. 11 days.

"It was believed at that time and later proven accurate that some of the terrorists involved in the incidents gained access to the United States through use of altered passports and false personal information," a judge wrote.

"Therefore, strict enforcement of immigration laws and laws pertaining to passports cannot be said to be of little weight or importance."

The Mustafas' lawyer called it racial profiling.

The Mustafas just wanted an apology.

■

In the months after his arrest, Fahti Mustafa's health began to deteriorate.

Earlier this year, he underwent heart bypass surgery, and later doctors found an infection in his arteries.

Mustafa, shamed by his arrest and subsequent weeks under electronic police surveillance, was haunted by the ordeal, his vitality weakened by bouts of depression.

His family worried about the elder Mustafa and frequently found him sitting in his living room, face drawn and eyes staring blankly.

"It affected him a lot, made him a lot more nervous; he gets more frustrated quickly," Nacer Mustafa said. "Anything can make him lose his temper. To him, it was humiliating and embarrassing — even though we did nothing wrong."

Nacer Mustafa said he sometimes still struggled with sadness and anxiety about his arrest, issues of race, fairness and retribution mingling with an equal desire to maintain equanimity.

"When I first got out, I was severely disturbed — I didn't feel like working or doing anything; I just wanted to stay with my family," said the father of two daughters.

He now spends at least 12 hours a day at his gas station in LaBelle.

"You get to a point where you really don't care what people think anymore," he said. "You have to worry about the problems right now rather than the problems you had before."

His faith in the United States may have been shaken, but Nacer Mustafa said his allegiance hadn't.

"I love my country. I'm proud of my heritage, and I'm not going anywhere."

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YEAR OF CHANGE

Southwest Floridians quiet soccer coach's fears, move beyond stereotypes

He looked like them. He had an accent like them. His name sounded like those of the terrorists who struck on Sept. 11.

In the hours, days and weeks that followed, Cape Coral youth soccer coach Mohammed Ali El-Zare could have been a victim of backlash and hate.

He wasn't. The parents, coaches and players in the Cape Coral Soccer Association didn't view him as a faceless member of a collective, impersonal "them."

He was known as Mo around Cape Coral soccer fields on Sept. 10. And he remained Mo, the soccer coach, the hard-working individual — not a stereotype.

He remains Mo even though he's no longer in Cape Coral. In June, he was hired as an assistant soccer coach at the University of South Alabama in Mobile.

He has fond memories of how he was treated last year.

"You don't know how supportive the community in the Fort Myers-Cape Coral area was," El-Zare said. "I was a person from the Middle East. I thought in the beginning I wouldn't be able to walk outside. I had a lot of people call me at home leaving kind words of encouragement.

"I've had a couple of people send me positive letters. It was a good feeling. There are good people that are not judging by what they see on TV."

In superficial ways, El-Zare, 34, fit stereotypes. He was born in Ethiopia and raised in Egypt. His parents live in Saudi Arabia. He was, until recently, a citizen of Yemen. He is Muslim.

Those weren't his defining characteristics, though, for the two Jewish men who hired him away from Florida International University in 1999 to serve as director of coaching for the Cape Coral program.

"Mohammed, if I wanted to pick his main religion, it's soccer," said John Steinweg, who along with Norm Rosen hired him in Cape Coral. They selected him for a simple reason. His credentials made him the best candidate for the job.

Cape Coral resident Marie Dyer, 39, had two daughters play for El-Zare. To Dyer, El-Zare wasn't a stereotype. He was Mo. After 9-11, she worried about Mo.

"Everybody kept in real close contact with him," Dyer said.

Nothing happened. Well, nothing bad. His Jewish and Christian friends looked out for him.

"They don't view him as an Egyptian, as a Middle Easterner," Steinweg said.



THE NEWS-PRESS FILE PHOTO

Just Mo. The soccer coach. Their friend.

"Their prayers are with me," El-Zare said. "They're there for me. I've had a lot of people who opened their homes to me during Christmas, during the holidays."

On Aug. 15, El-Zare officially became a U.S. citizen.

"It's a wonderful feeling," El-Zare said.

El-Zare came to America like millions before him — for freedom and opportunity.

"Definitely," El-Zare said. "Not only the land of opportunity. I've been able to grow as a person."

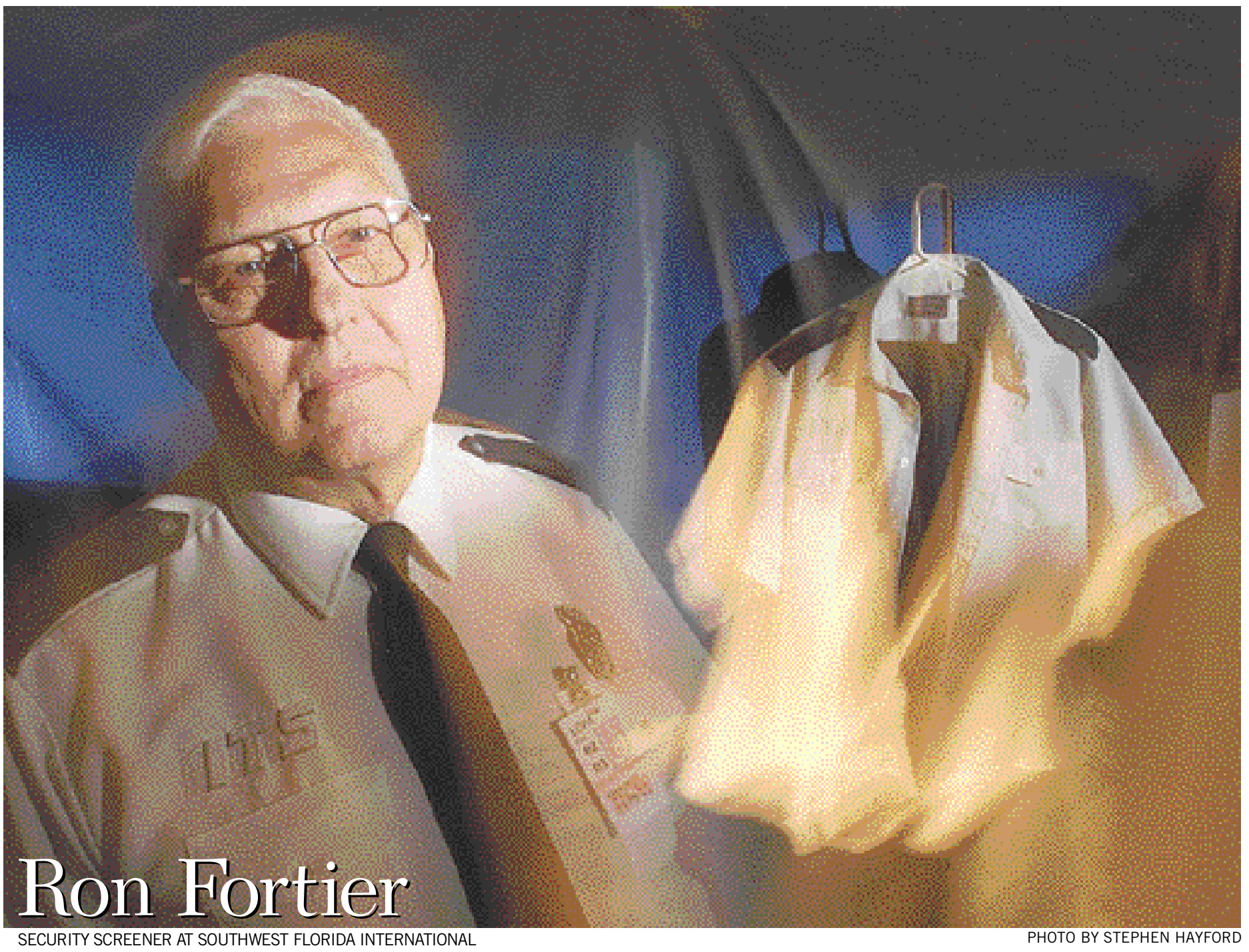
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SEE NEWS-PRESS.COM FOR "AN UNEASY ANNIVERSARY," A YEARLONG MULTIMEDIA CALENDAR

FIGHTING TERRORISM DOMESTICALLY

Cooperation waning on front line of airline security

Part-time job thrusts Ron Fortier into the trenches when attacks put fliers under heightened scrutiny • Laura Ruane reports



SECURITY SCREENER AT SOUTHWEST FLORIDA INTERNATIONAL

PHOTO BY STEPHEN HAYFORD

Ron Fortier sees his part-time job in a new light since the terrorist attacks on America.

"Before, it was just something I did," said the retired telecommunications supervisor from Muskegon, Mich.

After Sept. 11, "I got really excited about my job. I could see a purpose in it."

Fortier, 68, is a security screener at Southwest Florida International. His wife, Beth, spotted the help-wanted ad in the newspaper, and suggested he apply because "I like people and I like airplanes."

When he was younger, Fortier owned a small airplane, and held commercial and multiengine pilot's licenses. Now, he eats lunch seated by the wall of windows between the airport's two concourses, and watches jets taxi and take off.

He was inspecting carry-on bags in Concourse A when he first heard about a plane hitting the World Trade Center.

A few moments later, "all of the (TV) monitors went off. ... They didn't want people to see airplanes crash into the buildings."

Fortier ducked into the office of his employer, International Terminal Services, to watch a TV that was still on.

He phoned Beth at their home at Pine Lakes in North Fort Myers.

On his mind: Son Doug, a Northwest Airlines captain who pilots Boeing 757s, the same kind of aircraft that was hijacked. In those early minutes of the attack, details on the airlines involved were sketchy.

He got a busy signal. That's because Beth was replaying a phone message from their son, reporting that he was at home and OK.

At the security checkpoint, passengers streamed out after the public address system announced the airport would close.

"It was very, very quiet. People weren't talking."

When Fortier returned to work a few days later, passenger traffic had slowed to a trickle.

Gone were wisecracks about snooping in ladies' handbags or getting frisked. "You could have wrestled them to the ground, and they wouldn't have cared. They said things, like 'whatever you do, fine. Just make it safe. We appreciate you guys.'

"You could see the fear on their faces."

That newfound respect lasted about eight months.

"Now, they don't like the rules, especially the checking of shoes. They think it's a bother to take them off."

On the security side, there's little tolerance for anything stronger than a snide remark. Recently, an airport police officer chewed out a passenger who "took his shoes and slammed them up on the table," Fortier said.

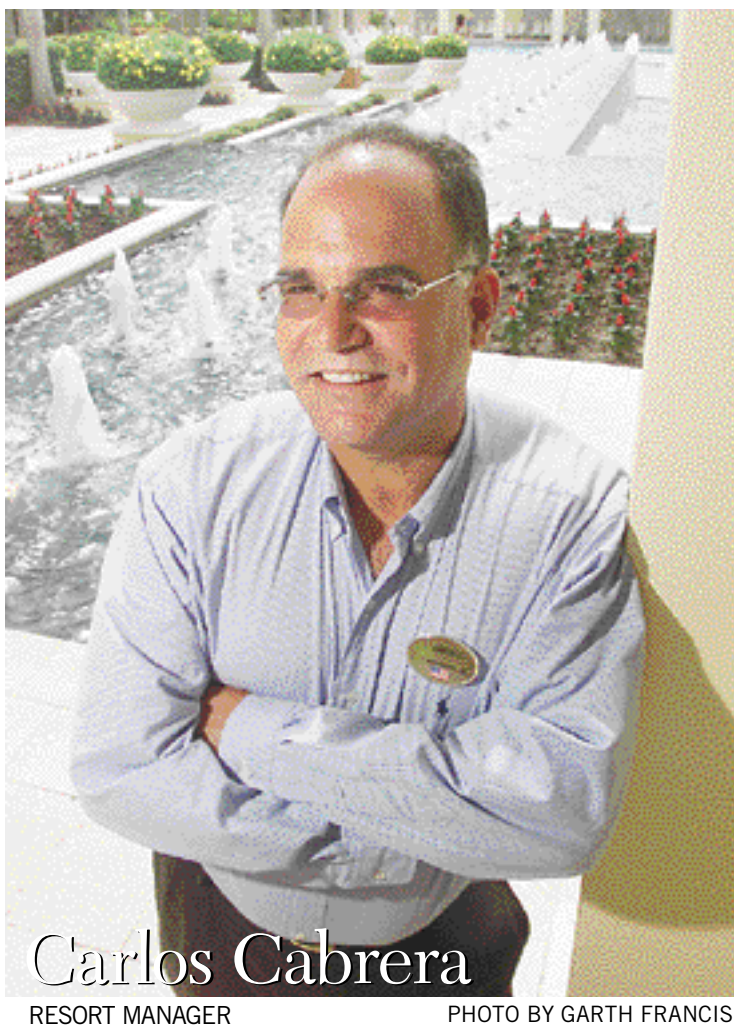
"Most times, though, you learn to say things, like 'Hey man, it's no picnic for me, either.' "

The Transportation Safety Administration — the agency charged with protecting the nation's airports — has a Nov. 19 deadline for replacing private screeners with an all-federal work force. Fortier has applied for a federal screening job, but isn't sure whether his preference for early shift and part-time work will be accommodated.

"We'll wait and see. Even if I'm out, what a tremendous experience it's been. No regrets."

"You could have wrestled them to the ground, and they wouldn't have cared. They said things, like 'whatever you do, fine. Just make it safe. We appreciate you guys.' You could see the fear on their faces."

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RESORT MANAGER

PHOTO BY GARTH FRANCIS

TOURISM TAKES A DIRECT HIT

Opening's grandeur tainted by tragedy

Hyatt Regency Coconut Point stays course despite downturn • Anne Mitchell reports

Hotel manager Carlos Cabrera was faced with a big dilemma just days after the terrorist attacks sent the nation reeling — and made Americans afraid to travel.

His new $150 million, 456-room luxury hotel, the Hyatt Regency Coconut Point in Estero, was scheduled to open and the staff of more than 300 was trained and ready.

Should he go ahead with the planned opening — or hold off until people got over the shock and started traveling again? By then, the region would have entered its peak winter tourist season as well.

After much soul-searching and a great deal of high-level discussions with the Hyatt Corp., Cabrera, a veteran hotelier, opted to open as planned.

"The smarter decision might have been to wait until January, but a commitment had been made to the employees," he said.

Several hundred new hires had been trained and the entire staff of 375 was "all pumped up", Cabrera said. Also, he didn't want to lose them.

Ironically, the hotel opened at capacity — filled by a contingent of U.S. Army Reserve officers.

The conference of the 81st Regional Support Command was cloaked in security in those nerve-wracking post-Sept. 11 days. The hotel's location, at the end of Coconut Road, provided a relatively secure compound for the commanders.

And the military, in turn, provided the new hotel recruits with some valuable experience in serving guests.

But it lasted only three days, after which business dropped off dramatically, Cabrera said.

To try to counteract losses, Cabrera said he "held new hires to about 375" — the existing ones. Now, with the worst over, he has begun to add staff for the winter season.

He also ran advertising promotions in Florida, the Midwest and Northeast offering free nights with a minimum stay of three nights.

"We set up a special budget of several hundred thousand dollars for promotions, and it paid off," he said.

Looking back, he observed, "In January, we turned the corner." Conventioneers and other guests started checking in.

And this summer has been better than expected, "mainly due to the Florida resident drive market."

All in all, Cabrera said he's down just 15 percent on what he expected for the first year of operation.

In August he was looking to hire about 160 more employees in time for the coming tourist season.

"The very, very good news is that 2003 looks like being very strong for the first two quarters. It will completely erase the shortfall, barring anything out of the ordinary happening," he said.

"The very, very good news is that 2003 looks like being very strong . . . It will completely erase the shortfall, barring anything out of the ordinary happening."

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YEAR OF CHANGE

Duty's call thwarts family plans

Last fall, Giovanna Kostrubala was about to begin civilian life. The U.S. Naval Academy graduate had served six years of active duty, most recently in the Middle East. She had just come home to Sanibel to run an art gallery with her mother, Teresa.

The September attacks sent the 29-year-old on a different path.

She reported for duty in Tampa.

"The hard part was leaving the family business. I knew it would be difficult for my parents to run the business," Kostrubala said.

But the family is steeped in military involvement. Her father Thaddeaus is a former Marine. Her brother is a cadet in the Air Force Academy. There was no question that Giovanna had to go.

"We all knew what was the right thing to do. I don't regret having done what I did at all. They knew it was the right thing to do," Giovanna said.

Teresa and Thaddeaus watch their children with a mix of pride and fear.

"Can they lose their lives in what they're doing? They have faced this. They have dealt with this," Thaddeaus Kostrubala said.

Giovanna lives in San Diego now, where she continues to serve in the reserves while training to be a Home Depot manager.

As the country's war on terrorism continues, she wonders whether she'll again don her uniform and defend the nation's freedom.

"I don't know what the future will bring," Giovanna said.

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NAVY LT. GIOVANNA KOSTRUBALA HUGS SISTER ANASTASIA BEFORE VOLUNTARILY REPORTING FOR DUTY IN NAVY INTELLIGENCE.

THE NEWS-PRESS FILE PHOTO

SEE NEWS-PRESS.COM TO LEARN ABOUT CHANGES AT SOUTHWEST FLORIDA INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT

SCHOOL REMEMBERS PRESIDENT'S VISIT ON A DAY OF TRAGEDY

Emma E. Booker Elementary School in Sarasota is not letting the tragedy of Sept. 11 ruin a big honor: President Bush chose the school to launch a national reading initiative that morning.

A famous photo shows a grave-looking Bush getting more news about the attacks from Chief of Staff Andrew Card. The president decided to do the reading anyway. To help them remember that day, the children put together an exhibit in the office lobby that includes two scrapbooks full of photos from White House photographers and a personal thank-you note from Bush. Photos of the chaos in New York share space with images of happy students and teachers preparing for the president's arrival.

"It was our time for him to be here," second-grade teacher Kay Daniels says.

"Tragically, other things happened that day which we had no control over."

THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

IN THE SPOTLIGHT

It's business as usual for flight teacher

Bonita Springs businessman's brush with terrorists unleashed a media feeding frenzy but no haunting regrets • Mike Hoyem reports



Rudi Dekkers

HUFFMAN AVIATION OWNER

PHOTOS BY STEPHEN HAYFORD

"I did 404 television interviews. I counted them. I did 400, 500, 600 newspaper interviews. I don't count newspaper interviews anymore. I can't."

Rudi Dekkers of Bonita Springs has gazed into a lot of cameras since Sept. 11, 2001.

"The only thing I've been doing is media," Dekkers said. "I did 404 television interviews. I counted them. I did 400, 500, 600 newspaper interviews. I don't count newspaper interviews anymore. I can't.

"I've gotten 10 phone calls a day every day from people all over the world who wanted to talk to me."

Dekkers, 46, no doubt has been one of the most interviewed men in America the past year — and for good reason. It was at his flight school, Huffman Aviation at the small Venice Municipal Airport, that terrorists Mohamed Atta and Marwan Al-Shehhi learned to fly.

A day after the World Trade Center was leveled, the Pentagon was smashed, thousands died and a nation was floored, Dekkers found himself surrounded by a dizzying horde of reporters, all of them asking what the terrorists were like and how it felt to know his school had taught them to fly.

Dekkers says the same things today he said then. He didn't like Atta, the terrorist ringleader he describes as "very cold" and "a living dead man."



"I am a businessman and did what I was supposed to do....I don't have nightmares at all. I sleep like a baby."

He says there's no way he could have known Atta and Al-Shehhi were part of the most diabolical plot ever to hit the United States.

"I wish I could have seen something because then I would have cut them to pieces myself," Dekkers said. "There's mass murderers in my facility. I wish I could have seen something."

Sitting in the lobby of the Ritz-Carlton Golf Resort at Tiburon in Naples — where he's already done two other interviews on this hot August day — Dekkers says he feels no guilt and suffers no nightmares.

"I am a businessman and did what I was supposed to do," Dekkers said. "When everything was checked, they saw that we did everything by the book. I don't have nightmares at all. I sleep like a baby."

A native of Amsterdam who has lived in Florida since 1992, Dekkers says he's talked with so many reporters the past year — a newsman who interviewed Atta's father, for example — that he's learned more about terrorism than the average person.

He believes America worries far too much about terrorism. And yet he says government regulations adopted since the disaster — particularly those affecting aviation — are little more than "window dressing" that won't stop fanatics if they're determined to attack.

"Terrorism is something that will always be there and has always been there," Dekkers said. "It will not disappear. We need to do what we can to protect ourselves, but we also need to live our lives and don't stand still. I believe we stand still a little too much in America."

Dekkers says the attacks shook the aviation industry so badly that many flight schools closed — including one he used to run in Naples.

He says Huffman Aviation, which he bought in June 1999, now survives mainly on gasoline sales, aircraft maintenance and a restaurant.

"I'm planning to sell part of my company," Dekkers said.

Dekkers and his wife, Astrid, have three daughters. Their oldest, Teressa, is expecting a baby and the due date, ironically, was today.

Dekkers says he's looking forward to "a new day, a new start" and wants to put Sept. 11 in the past.

"I'm not going to say I'm sick and tired of the media," Dekkers said. "That's not true. I apparently love the camera and apparently the camera loves me. But after 9-11, I hope this media thing is over. I think we all need to move on."

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YEAR OF CHANGE

Attacks' aftershocks scuttle hotel deal but can't quiet mergers for long

The terrorist attacks and the ensuing economic uncertainty nixed a merger between MeriStar Hospitality Corp. and FelCor Lodging Trust Inc. last year. FelCor pulled out of the $2.7 billion deal in September, after terrorism slashed both consumer and business travel.

The purchase was called off 10 days after the Sept. 11 attacks because the capital markets were, the companies said, in "disarray." By the time the deal ended, FelCor shares had fallen 36 percent, and MeriStar was down 57 percent.

Meristar Hospitality is one of the largest real estate investment trusts in the country.

FelCor is an Irving, Texas-based owner of hotels including Embassy Suites and Sheratons.

But MeriStar's hotel management company, MeriStar Hotels & Resorts, was in merger mode last August, when shareholders approved a $53.3 million deal with Interstate Hotels Corp. that would create the largest independent hotel operator in the country.

MeriStar Hotels & Resorts operates hotels nationwide including several in Southwest Florida, among them South Seas Plantation on Captiva Island and Sundial Resort on Sanibel. Meristar employs about 1,400 in Lee and Collier counties.

The deal would move Interstate's headquarters from western Pennsylvania to Washington, D.C., where MeriStar is based.



THE NEWS-PRESS FILE PHOTO

SOUTH SEAS PLANTATION ON CAPTIVA

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SEE NEWS-PRESS.COM TO WATCH AN NBC 2 REPORT ABOUT POST 9-11 TOURISM IN SOUTHWEST FLORIDA

BOOKSTORES WALK FINE LINE

A year after the attacks, bookstores across the country will mark the anniversary with readings, vigils and other events.They also will be selling books. "You walk a fine line," says Ann Binkley, a spokeswoman for the superstore chain Borders Group Inc."What you try to do is find a balance between offering what is out there without trying to exploit it."

More than 100 related works are due this fall.

THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

HEROES TO ICONS

Fame, attention serve as reminders

After a year viewed as heroes, firefighters say they want to shed the mantle • AP's Michael Lou reports

NEW YORK

John Hemsley spent his vacation in Myrtle Beach, S.C., trying to hide. He dodged questions about what he did for a living and wore no paraphernalia associated with his work.

"I spent my week trying to be incognito," he said.

Hemsley was tired of being a hero.

As a New York Fire Department captain in an Upper East Side firehouse that lost nine men in the attacks, Hemsley was thrust into the strange limelight of the post-Sept. 11 world, in which ordinary men suddenly became icons.

He's done a high school graduation, a grammar school moving-up ceremony, multiple church groups and too many benefit dinners to count. He's signed autographs, posed for pictures and given hugs. He's polished and repolished his speech, thanking the public and praising the American spirit.

"I felt an obligation to do it," he said. "But it was still overwhelming."

By the time summer arrived, "I was barely limping across the finish line."

In the altered cultural landscape after Sept. 11, New York firefighters and, to a lesser extent, NYPD and Port Authority police officers, have been elevated to almost mythic status. It is a mantle that some have relished, but most have worn uncomfortably.

In a profession that frowns on self-promotion, many have come to see the hero status as a burden, something they never asked for and feel they can't live up to. Others have even argued that it's dangerous.

"It's a big thing to have to shoulder," said firefighter Mike Heffernan, who lost his brother on Sept. 11. "Especially on top of the grieving you're still doing."

In the days immediately following Sept. 11, city firehouses became meccas of grief; firefighters, the objects of worship. Hundreds showed up with flowers, poems and gifts.

The flow has abated considerably, but some firehouses remain besieged.

In a profession that frowns on self-promotion, many have come to see the hero status as a burden, something they never asked for and feel they can't live up to.

"It's a big thing to have to shoulder. Especially on top of the grieving you're still doing."

— MIKE HEFFERNAN

In Lower Manhattan, when a fire company responds near ground zero, firefighters have to stop on the way back to sign autographs and work the crowd, said firefighter Tommy Narducci, a member of Engine 10.

"Anytime we're near the rig, forget it," he said. "It's photography central."

In the months that followed Sept. 11, as sales of firefighter action figures and anything FDNY skyrocketed, the department was bombarded with requests for public appearances. Gruff men, used to going to the corner bar after work, became speechmakers and black-tie dinner regulars. They popped champagne backstage with singer Bono of U2 and threw out the first pitch at playoff games. FDNY members served as pageant judges, graduation speakers and parade marshals. Countless appearances have taken them from Simsboro, La., to Paris, France.

The demand on police officers has been less, but some have been similarly flooded with invitations. Port Authority police dog handler David Lim, who was pulled from the rubble but lost his canine partner, Sirius, has rung the opening bell at the New York Stock Exchange, traveled to Alaska to start the Iditarod dog sled race and presided over the Chinese New Year Parade in San Francisco. At a recent charity auction he attended in San Diego, someone bought one of Lim's Port Authority hats for $650.

"After the anniversary," he hopes, "things will naturally calm down."

Hemsley, being a captain, shouldered much of the responsibility in his house, Engine 22, Ladder 13. His willingness, albeit reluctant, took the pressure off others, like firefighter Peter Clinton, one of just three men from the house's Sept. 11 day shift who lived.

Clinton, who found himself in demand as a "survivor," declined everything. "Even though it seems like a good thing ... eating for free, drinking for free, good looking girls," he said. "For me, it's like a burden."

The attention only reminds the men of the trauma of the day, and takes away from time with their families when they need it most.

"The Waldorf is nice, but not when you haven't seen your family in three days," Heffernan said.

The hero worship has interrupted the normal grieving process for firefighters, said Malachy Corrigan, director of the fire department's counseling services. In the past, firehouses were sanctuaries, places for healing.

With constant attention, however, "that's almost in suspension," he said.

Only in the past month or two, after the site closed, have firefighters been able to find the space to begin to reflect. One reflection: The pedestal they've been put on is unrealistic.

"We're just regular guys," Heffernan said.



A FIREFIGHTER WHO LOST HIS BROTHER ON SEPT. 11. THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

LIVING IN TERROR'S SHADOW

Instant, unprecedented wealth overwhelms victims' families

Still-grieving relatives confronted with reconciling the past, making plans for the future • GNS's Greg Barrett reports

NEW YORK

The wealthy had never felt more cursed. Gathered in a conference room at the New York Marriott was such a concentration of fortune and misfortune that one man rose as if to speak for the crowd.

"It feels like blood money," he said, and heads nodded in agreement.

Financial consultant Suze Orman, who had volunteered to advise families of the New York firefighters killed Sept. 11, could feel the full force of the World Trade Center's collapse. So many widows, so many blue-collar families, so many millionaires minted against their will.

The legacy of wealth left by the 343 firefighters was unlikely given any other ending. Typical firefighter salaries amount to roughly $60,000. By last Christmas, each victim's family should have received in excess of $300,000 just from one firefighter union. This doesn't count money from other unions, charities, the federal government, life insurance and pensions, all of which were expected to total $1 million to $2 million or more per family.



HER HUSBAND, PAUL, A FIREFIGHTER KILLED DURING THE 9-11 EFFORT GANNETT NEWS SERVICE

Orman had been summoned to the meeting on that spring Saturday for her money genius, but her counsel would be equal parts fiscal and mental. Lingering in the back of the room was a group of mothers who clung to their newborns as if the swaddled bundles were buoys. Orman had heard stories of expectant fathers dying in the World Trade Center's collapse, but to see the results in person was startling.

"You have to understand, everybody in that room was still in shock from Sept. 11," she recalled. "You could see it in their faces. They were not in their bodies."

A widow told Orman she had taken every Sept. 11 check to date and wadded it up in fits of disgust. She had $900,000 of uncashed charity stuffed like tissue in her purse.

Another said she had spent $15,000 on clothes she would probably never wear, hoping, in vain, to dull the pain.

And sitting quietly in an aisle seat that March day was one widow who had done exactly what Orman was about to suggest.

"It is OK to do nothing," Orman said emphatically. "Let the economy turn and let you know where it is going. ... Don't worry about the money right now."

For the first time since her firefighter husband, Paul, died somewhere in the debris of that first fallen tower, Cathi Tegtmeier exhaled.

"It was like she was talking directly to me," recalled the mother of two young children. "That was my permission to chill out."

In the immediate aftermath of Sept. 11, the charity was more of a burden than a blessing, said Tegtmeier, a trauma nurse for Westchester Medical Center.

After Sept. 11, Tegtmeier found herself dealing with ineffable grief, two distraught children and more money than she had ever imagined. It came unsolicited and by surprise in lump sums. She felt the urge to return it, the need to keep it, the responsibility to invest it.

"Nothing, nothing felt right," she said. "No decision felt right even if everything was logical."

Single checks were written for tens of thousands or even hundreds of thousands of dollars. Tegtmeier's total now exceeds $1 million. Plus there's Paul's tax-free pension of $4,000 monthly.

Slowly, the burden has become a blessing. She paid off the mortgage, the credit cards, finished the basement, upgraded from a 1995 Aurora Oldsmobile to a 2002 and set up trust funds and college funds for her children Aric, 7, and Andrea, 4.

She also returned to work part time for the hospital's helicopter response unit.

SEPT 11: DETAILS OF THE DAY'S EVENTS

8:00 **American Airlines Flight 11**, with 92 people on board, leaves Boston for Los Angeles.

8:14 **United Airlines Flight 175**, with 65 people on board, leaves Boston for Los Angeles.

8:21 **American Airlines Flight 77**, with 64 people on board, leaves Washington of Los Angeles.

8:40 FAA notifies NORAD about suspected hijacking of **American Flight 11**.

8:41 **United Air Lines Flight 93**, with 44 people on board, leaves Newark for San Francisco.

8:43 FAA notifies NORAD about suspected hijacking of **United Flight 175**.

8:46 **American Flight 11** crashes into north tower of World Trade Center.

9:03



United Flight 175 crashes into south tower of World Trade Center.

9:08 FAA bans all takeoffs nationwide for flights going to or through New York City airspace.

9:21 All bridges and tunnels into Manhattan closed.

9:24 FAA notifies NORAD's Northeast Air Defense Sector about suspected hijacking of **American Flight 77**.

9:26 FAA bans takeoffs of all civilian aircraft.

9:31 In Sarasota, President Bush calls crashes an "apparent terrorist attack on our country."

9:40 (approximately) **American Flight 77** crashes into Pentagon.

9:45 FAA orders all aircraft (more than 4,500) to land at nearest airport as soon as practical.

9:48 U.S. Capitol and White House's West Wing evacuated.

9:59 South tower of World Trade Center collapses.

10:07 United Flight 93 crashes in Pennsylvania field.

10:28 North tower of World Trade Center collapses.

11:00 New York mayor orders evacuation of lower Manhattan.

1:04 From Barksdale Air Force base in Louisiana, Bush announces U.S. military on high-alert worldwide.

2:51 Navy dispatches missile destroyers to New York, Washington.

3:07 Bush arrives at U.S. Strategic Command at Offutt Air Force Base in Nebraska.

5:25 Empty 47-story Seven World Trade Center collapses.

7:00 Bush arrives at White House.

8:30 Bush addresses nation and vows to "find those responsible and bring them to justice."

SEE NEWS-PRESS.COM FOR AMATEUR VIDEO OF SECOND CRASH, ALONG WITH A MULTIMEDIA TIME LINE

GETTING THERE

Skies unfriendly to darker-skinned travelers

Arab-looking fliers expect scrutiny now, left trying to lessen the shame • AP's Brad Foss reports

NEW YORK

Interrogations, body searches and suspicious stares are not the only sources of humiliation these days for air travelers with darker complexions and foreign names.

But many of the indignities endured by air travelers of Arab, Middle Eastern, South Asian and even South American backgrounds have been self-imposed — changes in behavior they have adopted just to get through the experience with a minimum of inconvenience and shame.

"I don't open my mouth in the plane," said Lebanese native Khaled Saffuri of Great Falls, Va.

Saffuri, 45, makes sure he shaves closely and puts on a suit every time he has to fly, even on weekends. To avoid the stares of fellow passengers inside airports, he recently joined United Airlines' $450-a-year Red Carpet Club, which gives him access to less-crowded lounges.

He hates driving, but has taken his car to West Virginia, Ohio and Michigan over the past six months just to escape the aggravation he faces when flying.

Nidal Ibrahim, the 35-year-old editor of Arab American Business Magazine, said he tries to get a seat in the back of the plane, far away from the cockpit, lest he make the flight attendants or other passengers nervous.

He also makes sure to go to the restroom before boarding to avoid making others fearful by getting out of his seat midflight.

"I'm also very careful about what I pack," said Ibrahim, a Californian who was born in the West Bank. "I debated long and hard recently about whether I was going to take a pen. I'm a writer and I'm debating whether I should take a damn pen."

The airlines deny they have engaged in racial profiling since the Sept. 11 hijack attacks, in which Islamic extremists struck at the World Trade Center in New York and the Pentagon in Washington.

Still, discrimination lawsuits are stacking up, filed by fliers outraged at what they considered to be abusive treatment. Plaintiffs include Arab-Americans, a permanent U.S. resident from the Phillippines and a U.S. citizen born in Guyana.

Some incidents have received extensive news coverage:

■ A flight bound for New York's LaGuardia Airport was escorted by a military plane after a passenger raised suspicions about a group of Indian travelers who were passing notes and changing seats. The group, which included a noted actress, was detained for questioning and released five hours later. Apparently they were just excited about seeing New York.

■ A pilot refused to fly an armed Arab-American Secret Service agent out of concern that his badge and photo ID were not genuine. The agent, a member of President Bush's security detail, did not get to Texas until the next day.

Less well-known are the steps being taken by many other fliers to avoid making headlines or seeing their travel plans disrupted.

Hassana Mardam Bey, a 29-year-old Syrian who lives in New York, said "you have to be extra polite." With light skin and Mediterranean features, Mardam Bey said it is her passport that triggers the questions and body searches from security workers.

"You always feel guilty for no reason," she said. She now rides Amtrak when traveling to Boston or Washington.

Kazandra Bonner, a 29-year-old multimedia producer who lives in New York, said she has been pulled aside by security workers for "random" checks so many times since Sept. 11 that she now asks her boyfriend to board separately, taking her carry-on luggage with him.

"Once the mark is on you, it seems like you can't shake it," said Bonner, whose theories about why she gets selected for extra screening range from her skin color (her mother is from Peru) to the unusual spelling of her first name.

Having to take extra measures to avoid embarrassment and delays can carry an emotional toll over time and lead to depression, feelings of inadequacy and other stress-related disorders, according to David Rollock, an associate professor of psychology at Purdue University.



EDITOR OF ARAB-AMERICAN BUSINESS MAGAZINE

THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

"I debated long and hard recently about whether I was going to take a pen. I'm a writer and I'm debating whether I should take a damn pen."

LEGAL RIGHTS

Moves to make us more secure have opposite effect on some

Terrorist attacks prompt changes in Americans' legal rights after Sept. 11 • AP's David Kravets reports

The government has imposed many new limits on Americans' legal rights as it fights a war on terror, fundamentally altering the nation's delicate balance between liberty and security.

The changes — including the authority in terror cases to imprison Americans indefinitely, without charges or defense lawyers — substantially expand the government's ability to investigate, arrest, try and detain.

They grant law enforcement easier access to Americans' personal lives while keeping many government operations secret. And the idea that law-abiding citizens can freely associate with other law-abiding citizens without the threat of government surveillance no longer holds.

The Bush administration will not abuse these far-reaching powers, said Viet Dinh, an assistant U.S. attorney general: "I think security exists for liberty to flourish and liberty cannot exist without order and security," Dinh said.

"I think security exists for liberty to flourish and liberty cannot exist without order and security."

— VIET DINH, AN ASSISTANT U.S. ATTORNEY GENERAL

Still, even supporters are wary.

"One has to pray that those powers are used responsibly," said Charlie Intriago, a former federal prosecutor and money-laundering expert in Miami who said the new provisions could help intercept terrorists' finances.

The USA Patriot Act, hurriedly adopted by Congress and signed by Bush six weeks after the terror attacks, tipped laws in the government's favor in 350 subject areas involving 40 federal agencies.

The Bush administration has since imposed other legal changes without congressional consent, such as allowing federal agents to monitor attorney-client conversations in federal prisons, and encouraging bureaucrats to deny public access to many documents requested under the Freedom of Information Act.

The FBI can monitor political and religious meetings inside the United States now, even when there's no suspicion a crime has been committed — a policy abandoned in the 1970s amid outrage over J. Edgar Hoover's surveillance of the Rev. Martin Luther King Jr. and other activists.

The American Civil Liberties Union, media companies and other organizations are challenging many of the changes, and judges have ruled against the administration in a few early cases. The U.S. Supreme Court has yet to rule on any of the challenges.

"Are we any safer as a nation? I don't know," said Anthony Romero, the ACLU's executive director. "Are we less free? You bet."

In a poll conducted for The Associated Press by ICR/International Communications Research of Media, Pa., 63 percent said they were concerned that the new measures could end up restricting Americans' individual freedoms. Of those, 30 percent of the 1,001 responding adults were "very concerned" and 33 percent "somewhat concerned."

The telephone poll taken Aug. 2-6 has an error margin of 3 percentage points.

In interviews, some people express concern, while others say they are not worried.

Americans may never know how valid their concerns are, since everything about terror-related investigations is secret. The administration isn't required to disclose how it is implementing the fundamental changes, making oversight — let alone court challenges — exceedingly difficult.

The Patriot Act allows searches for medical and financial records, computer and telephone communications, even for the library books Americans borrow.

Judges approve these top-secret warrants in the secret Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Act court. Established to target "foreign powers," FISA now also applies to U.S. citizens.

Dinh credited these changes with reducing the risk of terror, but he wouldn't reveal specifics.

However, even the FISA court isn't bulletproof. In an opinion announced Aug. 22, FISA judges said the FBI has misled the court 75 times in the past and said the Justice Department has wrongly shared intelligence information with criminal prosecutors who are supposed to meet a tougher standard for evidence.

The administration is appealing that decision to a secret FISA appellate panel, saying it undermines powers Congress granted under the Patriot Act.

Thousands of Middle Eastern men who entered the United States since 2000 have been questioned and detained. Many were quietly deported after immigration hearings that are no longer public.

On Aug. 26, the administration suffered another blow when a federal appeals panel in Cincinnati ruled these secret immigration hearings unconstitutional.

"Democracies die behind closed doors," these judges said.

IN REVIEW: KEY DATES OF THE PAST YEAR

9-12 2001 Bush labels attacks "acts of war," asks Congress to devote $20 billion to recovery, allies to join war on terrorism. NATO declares terrorism an attack on all 19 member states.

9-13



Secretary of State Colin Powell identifies Osama bin Laden as prime suspect. Limited commercial flights resume. Major-league weekend games canceled.

9-14 Justice Department names 19 suspects in attacks; intelligence sources link them directly to bin Laden. Bush calls up 50,000 reservists. Afghanistan's ruling Taliban warns of revenge if United States attacks. Bush leads nation in prayer at National Cathedral.

9-17 Wall Street trading resumes, ending stock market's longest shutdown since the Depression. Dow loses 684.81 points, its worst-ever one-day point drop.

9-18 Taliban leaders call on Muslims to wage holy war on United States if it attacks.

9-19 Pentagon orders combat aircraft to Persian Gulf bases. American and United airlines announce 40,000 layoffs.

9-20 Bush announces new Cabinet-level Office of Homeland Security, to be led by Pennsylvania Gov. Tom Ridge.

9-24 Bush orders U.S. financial institutions to freeze assets of 27 groups and individuals suspected of supporting terrorists.

9-27 Bush announces plan to bolster airline security, including expanded use of federal marshals on airliners.

10-5 Tabloid photo editor Robert Stevens dies of anthrax in Florida, in nation's first known case of inhalation version of disease since 1976; a total of five people eventually die.

10-7 First airstrikes launched in Afghanistan; targets include capital of Kabul, bin Laden training camps and Taliban bases. Bin Laden, in videotaped message, praises God for Sept. 11 attacks and swears America will never "dream of security" until "the infidels' armies leave the land of Muhammad."

10-14 Bush rejects Taliban offer to discuss turning over bin Laden if U.S. ends bombing.

10-15 Officials announce anthrax spores found in letter to Senate Majority Leader Tom Daschle.

10-26 Bush signs anti-terrorism bill giving police unprecedented ability to search, seize, detain and eavesdrop in pursuit of possible terrorists.

10-28 Thousands of relatives of World Trade Center victims gather at site for first official memorial.

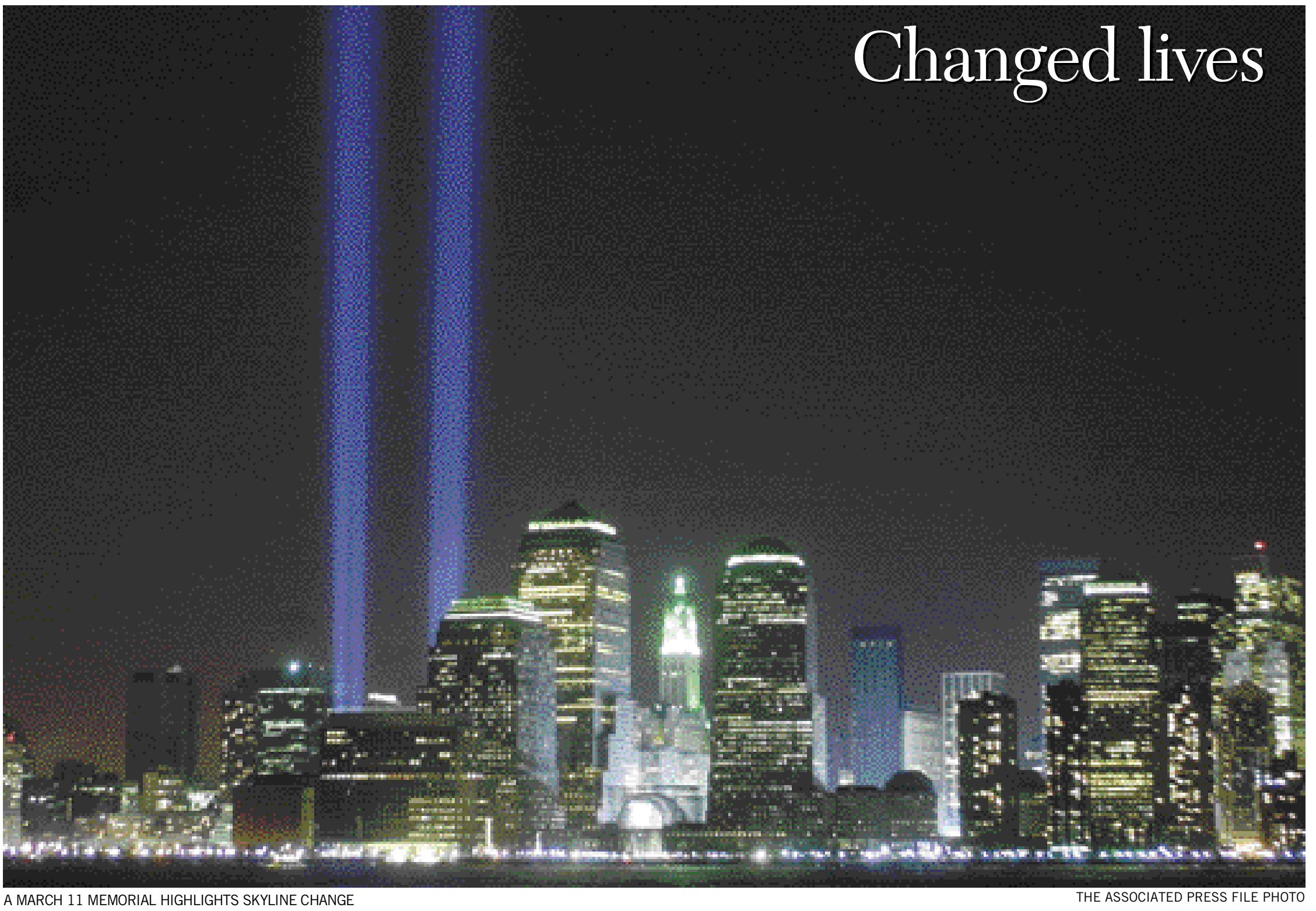
10-28 American Red Cross stops accepting donations to terrorism victims fund after raising more than $500 million.

SEE NEWS-PRESS.COM FOR A SHORT MOVIE ABOUT WHERE THE TOWERS STOOD

EMOTIONAL TOLL

Chorus of tributes brings tragedy within reach

From artwork to time capsules, memorials important for people to grasp enormity of event • AP's Sharon Cohen reports



A MARCH 11 MEMORIAL HIGHLIGHTS SKYLINE CHANGE

THE ASSOCIATED PRESS FILE PHOTO

"I just felt in my heart that if I could tell my kids, 'This is from ground zero; people died next to this beam,' ... it will retain the reality of that experience longer."

— KEN SENTER, HISTORY TEACHER

History teacher Ken Senter has a plan to capture the horror of the Sept. 11 terrorist attacks for his students in Tennessee. He'll take them outside.

Two beams salvaged from the ruins of the World Trade Center — battered hunks of steel he received after lobbying New York officials for nearly a year — will be shaped into a memorial in front of Oak Ridge High School.

"I just felt in my heart that if I could tell my kids, 'This is from ground zero; people died next to this beam,' ... it will retain the reality of that experience longer," Senter said.

Communities across the nation responded with an outpouring of generosity and grief after last September's attacks.

A year later, America has turned to commemorating the tragedy in concrete and steel, in words and fabric, in churches, museums, and even tattoo parlors. There are scholarships and songs, quilts and paintings, exhibits and displays, videos and tens of thousands of Web sites. There are public memorials that will scrape the sky and private mementos already buried in the earth.

"There's a desperate need for people to be connected," said Nick Carpasso, an art historian in Massachusetts and expert on public memorials.

And having an artifact brings the tragedy home, said Mark Schaming, director of exhibitions at the New York State Museum.

"It's human nature to have a touchstone and be closer to a historical event," he said. "The farther away you are, the greater the need for it."

Consider the rusty beams that once made up the 110-story towers. Communities around the nation — including Charlotte, N.C. and Lafayette, La. — have dispatched trucks to claim them for displays.

In Naperville, Ill., beams — along with rubble from the Pentagon — will become part of a memorial for Cmdr. Dan Shanower, a hometown boy and naval officer killed in the building.

Not all memorials are meant to be seen.

In Ridgewood, N.J., a New York suburb, families of 12 victims buried a vault containing photos, baseball caps and other remembrances from their loved ones. Those who died left behind 24 school-age children.

Some have commemorated Sept. 11 in a way America has traditionally honored presidents and famous people: renaming streets, schools, public buildings, athletic fields, commuter ferry boats.

Hundreds of New York firefighters have gotten a Sept. 11 memorial tattoo.

Michael DeMinico, a 50-year-old Florida trial lawyer who also is a painter, wants to capture on canvas all those who died in the attacks.

A mangled red fire truck from Engine Company 6, buried under a pedestrian bridge when the north tower collapsed on it, will be featured at the New York State Museum along with an oral history.

New York Police Sgt. Rich Knoeller, an amateur pilot who lost his brother-in-law in the attacks, was a flag bearer in a flying memorial down the Hudson River. He remembers the awe he once felt flying past the trade center and the emptiness he now feels. But he hopes that won't last forever.

"One day, some day," he said wistfully, "there will be two more towers I can fly by."

LIVING IN TERROR'S SHADOW

Flight 93 crash town remains thankful

Shanksville residents say heroes likely saved lives • GNS's Greg Barrett reports

SHANKSVILLE, PA.

The elderly man with his back to the street did an about-face when he heard the caravan approaching. His salute was crisp and heartfelt.

There would be hundreds more just like it as the processional of buses ferried family members to the rural Pennsylvania site where United Flight 93 had crashed six days earlier.

Shanksville's residents had gathered along the streets in awe in the aftermath of Sept. 11. So many that its population seemed far more than its official 245, recalled author and Red Cross counselor Glenn Kashurba.

On every block there were salutes and American flags and handwritten signs: Thank you. God Bless Flight 93. We Shall Never Forget.

Kashurba says America's war on terrorism began here as passengers fought hijackers to regain control of the airplane.

If the 40 passengers and crew of Flight 93 had to die Sept. 11, there was no better place than this, one grieving mother told Kashurba.

Flight 93 burrowed into a field two miles from the district's only school and its 500 prekindergarten to senior high school students. The following day, classes resumed with mental health counselors on hand.

The students soon were gleaning lessons from Sept. 11; studying different cultures, such as those of the Middle East, and different religions, such as Islam. "It presented us with a lot of interesting studies," said Superintendent Gary Singel.

"It's absolutely amazing to us that the plane came down where it did. It's the only place within a 10-mile radius" where it could have crashed without claiming additional lives.

Today, there's a new sign erected at Shanksville's border. It's posted on the same route that ushered the buses into town.

"Welcome to Shanksville: A Friendly Little Town."



A MEMORIAL TO THE HEROES OF UNITED FLIGHT 93

GANNETT NEWS SERVICE

IN REVIEW: KEY DATES OF THE PAST YEAR

11-7 Federal agents raid U.S. businesses suspected of helping funnel millions of dollars to bin Laden's network. Bush asks at least nine countries to freeze assets that aid bin Laden and al-Qaida.

11-9 Taliban abandon strategic northern Afghan city of Mazar-e-Sharif, allowing Northern Alliance to take control.

11-13 Northern Alliance troops enter Kabul after flight of Taliban forces that had ousted them in 1996.

11-19 Bush signs law to hire 28,000 federal workers to screen passengers and baggage.

11-25 First wave of Marines lands near Taliban stronghold of Kandahar. CIA officer Johnny Micheal Spann killed by rioting prisoners at Mazar-e-Sharif.

12-1



Northern Alliance forces turn over to U.S. custody John Walker Lindh, an American who fought with the Taliban.

12-11 First criminal charges in Sept. 11 attacks brought against Zacarias Moussaoui.

12-22 British citizen Richard Reid allegedly tries to blow up Miami-bound jet using bomb hidden in shoe. Hamid Karzai and his transitional government sworn in.

12-28 Bush signals bin Laden may never be caught, saying "Our objective is more than bin Laden."

2-13 2002 Lindh pleads innocent to a 10-count federal indictment charging him with aiding bin Laden's terrorist network.

2-17 Federal government assumes control of security at nation's 429 commercial airports.

3-18 U.S. commanders declare end of Operation Anaconda, the largest U.S.-led ground operation in Afghan campaign, but many Taliban and al-Qaida fighters slip through to Pakistan.

5-28 Last standing steel beam from trade center cut down during ground zero ceremony.

7-1 U.S. air raid in Uruzgan province kills 46 civilians, including 25 at a wedding party; Afghan government and U.S. military dispute the facts.

7-15 Lindh pleads guilty to supplying services to Taliban and carrying explosives during commission of a felony and agrees to cooperate with investigators.

7-15



Ceremony ends 10 months of sifting through trade center ruins.

8-15 More than 600 family members of Sept. 11 victims file trillion-dollar federal lawsuit against Saudi officials and institutions.

8-17 Moussaoui trial delayed until Jan. 6, 2003.

SEE NEWS-PRESS.COM FOR ARCHIVED NBC COVERAGE OF THE FIRST HOURS AFTER THE ATTACK